

DEDICATED PRELIM PROGRAM(DPP)**UPSC-CSE PRELIMINARY TEST SERIES – 2021/2022****DO NOT OPEN THIS TEST BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO****TEST BOOKLET SERIES****Test Code:****DPP****TEST BOOKLET
GENERAL STUDIES
TEST -04****E4****Time Allowed: Two Hours****Maximum Marks : 200****INSTRUCTIONS**

1. IMMEDIATELY AFTER THE COMMENCEMENT OF THE EXAMINATION, YOU SHOULD CHECK THAT THIS TEST BOOKLET DOES NOT HAVE ANY UNPRINTED OR TORN OR MISSING PAGES OR ITEMS, ETC.

2. ENCODE CLEARLY THE TEST BOOKLET SERIES CODE A, B, C OR D AS THE CASE MAY BE IN THE APPROPRIATE PLACE IN THE ANSWER SHEET.

3. You have to enter your Roll Number on the Test Booklet in the provided alongside this line. DO NOT write anything else on the Test Booklet.

4. This Test Booklet contains 100 questions. Each question is printed in English. Each item comprises four responses (answers). You will select the response which you want to mark on the Answer Sheet. In case you feel that there is more than one correct response, mark the response which you consider the best. In any case, choose ONLY ONE response for each item.

5. All items carry equal marks.

6. Penalty for wrong answers:

THERE WILL BE PENALTY FOR WRONG ANSWERS MARKED BY A CANDIDATE IN THE OBJECTIVE TYPE QUESTION PAPERS.

- I. There are four alternatives for the answer to every question. For each question for which a wrong answer has been given by the candidate, One-Third of the marks assigned to that question will be deducted as penalty.
- II. If a candidate gives more than one answer, it will be treated as a wrong answer even if one of the given answers happens to be correct and there will be same penalty as above to that question.
- III. If a question is left blank, i.e., no answer is given by the candidate, there will be no penalty for that question.

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TOPICS COVERD: President, Vice-President, Prime Minister, Governor, Chief minister, Supreme court
High court, Union CoM, Cabinet secretary, State CoM, Chief secretary, Anti-defection Laws,
5th & 6th schedule



Q.1) Which of the following Veto Power is exercised by the President of India?

1. Absolute Veto
2. Qualified Veto
3. Suspensive Veto
4. Pocket Veto

Select the correct Ans: from the code given below:

- a) 1,2 and 3 only
- b) 2,3 and 4 only
- c) 1,3 and 4 only
- d) All of the above

Q.2) With reference to the President, consider the following statements:

1. He decides on disqualification of Members of Parliament in consultation with the Speaker.
2. He can seek advice from the Supreme Court and such advice tendered is binding on the President.
3. The President of India does not possess veto power with respect to the Constitution Amendment Bill.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) Only 1
- b) 1 and 2
- c) 2 and 3
- d) Only 3

Q.3) With reference to the President of India, Consider the following statements.

1. The resolution for impeachment charges of the president should be signed by one-third member of the house in which charges have been framed.
2. The Constitution defines the meaning of ground for the impeachment of the President.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.4) Consider the following statement about the vacancy in the president office after expiration of the term of the sitting President:

1. An election to fill the vacancy must be completed before the expiration of the term of the sitting President.
2. President must continue to hold the office until his successor enters upon his office.
3. The Vice President acts as the President after the expiration of the term of sitting the President until the new President is elected.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1, 2 and 3
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.5) With reference to the Ordinance making power of the President, Consider the following statements.

1. The power of the President to issue an ordinance is parallel to the power of legislation.
2. The President can issue an ordinance only when both the Houses of the Parliament are not in session.
3. The President can make an ordinance only when he is satisfied that the circumstances exist that render it necessary for him to take immediate action.
4. The decision of the President to issue an ordinance cannot be challenged in a court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2, 3 and 4 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 4 only

Q.6) Consider the following statements.

1. Any of the doubts and disputes relating to the election of Vice-President is decided by the Supreme Court whose decision is final.
2. Election of the Vice president can be challenged on the ground of any vacancy in the Electoral College.
3. The Vice-President of India is modeled on the lines of the Vice-President of America but with some difference.
4. The Vice-President of India does not assume the office of the President when it falls vacant for the unexpired term like Vice-President of America.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 and 3 only
- c) 1, 3, and 4 only
- d) 1 and 4 only



Q.7) The electoral college of Vice-President is different from the electoral college of President in the following ways.

1. It consists of both elected and nominated members of the Parliament of India.
2. It includes the elected members of the state legislative assemblies.
3. It also includes the elected members of the legislative assemblies of the Union Territories of Delhi and Puducherry.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 1,2, and 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.8) With reference to the Prime Minister, consider the following statement.

1. The Constitution of India does not contain any specific procedure for the selection and appointment of the Prime Minister.
2. The term of the office of the Prime Minister is fixed for 5 years.
3. He/ She can bring about the collapse of the council of ministers by resigning from office.
4. He/ She does not have the power to recommend the dissolution of the Lok Sabha to the President.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.9) Consider the following statements with reference to power of the Prime Minister in relation to Parliament.

1. Prime minister advises the President for summoning and proroguing of sessions of the Parliament.
2. Prime minister announces policies of the government on the floor of the House.
3. Prime minister advises the President with regard to the appointment of important officials like attorney general of India, CAG, chairman and members of UPSC, and so on.
4. Prime minister is the principal channel of communication between the President and the council of ministers.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.10) With reference to the pardoning power of the President, consider the following statements:

1. The objective of the pardoning power of the President is to correct any judicial error in the operation of the law.
2. The pardoning power of the President is similar to the pardoning power of the Governor.
3. It is also used to afford relief from a sentence, which the President regards as unduly harsh.
4. The pardoning power is exercised by the President on the advice of the council of ministers.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1, 2, and 3 only
- b) 1 and 4 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,3 and 4 only

Q.11) Match List I and with List II and select the correct Ans:

List I

A. Pardon
all sentences.

B. Commutation
due to some special fact.

C. Remission
sentence without changing its character

D. Respite
sentence for a temporary period.

List II

1. Absolves the convict from

2. Awarding lesser sentences

3. Reducing the period of

4. Stay of the execution of a

5. Substitution of one form of
punishment for a lighter form.

Select the correct Ans: from code given below:

- a) A-1, B-5, C-3, D-2
- b) A-1, B-5, C-3, D-4
- c) A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
- d) A-3, B-2, C-1, D-5

Q.12) Consider the following statements:

1. Discretionary Powers exercised by the Governor cannot be questioned by the Court.



2. The Governor can return a money bill for the reconsideration of the state legislature.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) Only 1
- b) Only 2
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.13) Regarding the position of Governor, consider the following statements:

1. The same person cannot be appointed as the Governor for two or more states.
2. The office of Governor is an independent Constitutional office but it is subordinate to the Central Government.
3. The oath of the office to the Governor is administered by the President of India.
4. The Governor can only appoint members of the State Public Service Commission. However, he cannot remove them.

Which of the above statements is /are correct?

- a) 1 and 2
- b) 3 only
- c) 1 and 4
- d) 4 only

Q.14) Consider the following statements.

1. The chief justice of the concerned state high court may be appointed temporarily to discharge the functions of the governor of that state.
2. The governor can be removed from office on the ground of the 'violation of the Constitution' as stated in the Constitution.
3. Pleasure of the President for removal of the governor is justifiable.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.15) With reference to the Governor, consider the following statements.

1. He/She can grant pardons, reprieves, respites, and remission of punishment or suspend, remit and commute the sentence of any person convicted of

any offence, outside the jurisdiction of the state executive power.

2. The Governor is consulted by the President while appointing the judges of the concerned high court.
3. Governor can also pardon the death sentence of a person.
4. Governor makes appointments, postings and promotions of the district judges in consultation with the state high court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 and 4 only
- d) 2 and 4 only

Q.16) Consider the following statements.

1. The discretionary power of the Governor is greater than the discretionary power of the President.
2. The Governor has only situational discretionary power and not Constitutional discretion.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.17) What special powers are given to the Governor in case of tribal areas under sixth schedule?

1. The Governor can organize and reorganize the autonomous districts.
2. In case of different tribes in an autonomous district, the governor can divide the district into several autonomous regions.
3. He/ She can declare an area to be a scheduled area.
4. The Governor is empowered to appoint a commission to examine and report on any matter relating to the administration of the autonomous districts or regions.

Which of the statements given above is /are correct?

- a) 1, 2 and 3 only
- b) 1, 2 and 4 only
- c) 2, 3 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.18) What powers of the Chief Minister are in relation to the Council of ministers?

1. He allocates and reshuffles the portfolios among the ministers.
2. He brings about the collapse of the council of ministers by resigning from office.



3. He communicates to the governor of the state all the decisions of the council of the ministers.
4. He announces the government policies on the floor of the house.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1, 2, and 3 only
- c) 1 and 4 only
- d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Q.19) Consider the following statements:

1. There shall be a council of ministers with the Chief Minister as the head to aid and advise the Governor for the exercise of his functions unless he wants to exercise his functions on his discretion.
2. It shall be the duty of the Council of Ministers to communicate to the Governor of the state all decisions of the Council of Ministers.
3. The Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the Legislative council of the State

Which of the statements given above is/ are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2, and 3

Q.20) Consider the following with reference to the powers of the Governor:

1. He can appoint any member of the state legislative assembly to preside over proceedings when the offices of both the Speaker and the Deputy Speaker fall vacant.
2. He decides on the question of disqualification of members of the state legislature in consultation with the Election Commission.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.21) With reference to the Supreme Court of India, consider the following statements-

- 1) The Supreme Court can punish any person for its contempt.
- 2) The parliament is not authorised to expand the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court.
- 3) The constitution authorises the president to seek the opinion of the Supreme Court in any matter.

Which of the above statements is / are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 only
- d) All of the above

Q.22) Consider the following statements regarding the writ jurisdiction of the supreme court-

1. The jurisdiction of the Supreme Court is exclusive regarding writs.
2. An aggrieved person has to compulsorily approach the High Court first for the enforcement of their fundamental rights.
3. The writ jurisdiction of the high court is wider than that of the Supreme Court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 3 only

Q.23) Consider the following pairs -

Writs	Implications
1. Certiorari	Issued on Grounds of excess of jurisdiction.
2. Mandamus	Prevents illegal holding of public office by a person.
3. Habeas corpus	Protection of an individual against arbitrary detention.

Which of the above pairs given above is / are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 2 only

Q.24) In context of high court's, consider the following statements-

1. The judges of the High Court are appointed by the governor of the respective state.
2. The constitution has prescribed a minimum age for appointment as judge of the High Court.
3. A judge of a High Court can be removed from his office by the president only.

Which of the following statements given above is / are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 2 only



Q.25) With reference to the high court of India, consider the following statements-

1. A High Court is barred from considering the constitutional validity of any Central law.
2. The law of a high court is binding on all subordinate courts functioning within its territorial jurisdiction.
3. A High Court has the power to review and correct its own judgement.

Which of the statements given above is / are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.26) Consider the following statements with respect to the High courts of India:

1. The Parliament can extend the jurisdiction of the High Court to any union territory.
2. the salaries, allowances and pension of a High Court judge is charged on the consolidated fund of the state.
3. The Writ jurisdiction of the high court falls under the basic structure of the constitution.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.27) Which of the following constitutes the original jurisdiction of High Court-

1. Enforcement of fundamental rights of citizens.
2. Disputes relating to election of members of parliament.
3. Matters of contempt of court

Select the correct Ans: using the code below-

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 and 4 only
- c) 1 only
- d) All of the above

Q.28) Consider the following statements with respect to the Supreme Court of India:

1. The constitution of India provides for Collegium system for appointment of judges
2. The Chief Justice of India can appoint a judge of a High Court as an ad hoc judge of the Supreme Court.

3. No Judge can take up the matter on his own, unless allocated by the Chief Justice of India.

Which of the statements given above is / are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.29) Consider the following statements regarding High Courts

1. It has power of superintendence over all courts and tribunals in its territorial jurisdiction including military courts
2. It has the power to review and correct its own judgment as the specific power of review is conferred to it by Constitution
3. It has the power of judicial review to examine the constitutionality of orders and laws of both the Central and State governments

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2
- b) 2 and 3
- c) 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.30) Consider the following statements

1. The salaries, allowances, privileges of the judges of the High Court are determined by the State legislature
2. The Constitution does not contain detailed provisions with regard to the jurisdiction and powers of a High Court

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 and 2

Q.31) Consider the following statements regarding qualification for the Appointment of District Judge

1. He/she should not already be in the service of Central or State government
2. He/she should have been an advocate or a pleader for 10 years
3. He/she should be recommended by the Supreme Court for appointment

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only



- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.32) Consider the following statements regarding the Transfer of Judges

1. The President can transfer a judge from one High court to another after consulting the Governor of the state
2. Only the judge who is transferred can challenge the arbitrariness of transfer.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 and 2

Q.33) Consider the following statements

1. President can establish a common High Court for two or more states
2. The parliament can extend the jurisdiction of a High Court to any Union Territory
3. A person appointed as a judge of High court has to make and subscribe oath before the Governor

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2
- b) 1 and 3
- c) 2 only
- d) 2 and 3

Q.34) Consider the following statements

1. The appellate jurisdiction of a High Court is wider than its Original Jurisdiction
2. The provisions of Articles 13 and 226 explicitly confer the powers of Judicial Review on a High Court

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 and 2

Q.35) Which of the following provisions were added to the Constitution by the 91st Amendment Act?

1. The total number of ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the Central Council of Ministers shall not exceed 15 per cent of the total strength of the parliament.
2. A Member of Parliament disqualified on the ground of defection shall be disqualified to be appointed as a Minister.

3. A Member of Parliament disqualified on the ground of defection shall be disqualified to hold any remunerative political post.

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the Above

Q.36) With reference to the anti-defection law, consider the following statements:

1. The constitution empowers the President to make rules to give effect to the provisions of the tenth schedule.
2. According to the rules, the presiding officer is empowered to take up a defection case suo motu.
3. Any question regarding the disqualification of a member arising out of defection is to be decided by the Presiding officer of the house.

Which of the above statements is incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.37) In the context of the Cabinet Secretary of India, consider the following statements-

1. Cabinet Secretary is the senior-most civil servant in India.
2. She/He ranks on the same level as the Attorney General of India in the order of precedence.
3. A cabinet Secretary is appointed for a fixed tenure of two years.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.38) Consider the following statements regarding the chief secretary of state in India-

1. Chief-Secretary acts as a secretary to the Central cabinet of India.
2. He looks after all those matters which do not fall within the purview of other secretaries.
3. The civil services board is headed by the Chief Secretary of a state.

Which of the statements given above is / are incorrect?

- a) 1 only



- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.39) Consider the following statements regarding the Union Council of Ministers-

1. The Council of Ministers Immediately ceased to hold office immediately after the dissolution of the Lok Sabha.
2. Council of Ministers exercise control over the appointments of the constitutional authorities.
3. The president can ask the Council of Ministers to reconsider the advice tendered by them.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 2 and 3 only
- b) 1 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.40) Consider the following Pairs-

Concept

Meaning

1. Collective Responsibility Cabinet decisions binding on all cabinet ministers
2. Parliamentary Responsibility Duty of the Ministers to hold the Parliament sessions diligently.
3. Individual Responsibility Ministers hold office during the pleasure of the Governor.

Select the correct Ans: using the codes below-

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.41) Consider the following statements about 5th schedule of Indian Constitution

1. President is empowered to declare an area as scheduled area
2. Governor can alter the boundary of Scheduled areas.
3. Tribes advisory councils can only be established in states which have areas under 5th schedule.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 1 only

- c) 2 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.42) Consider the following statements about Sixth schedule

1. Sixth schedule extends to state of Assam, Meghalaya, Mizoram and Manipur
2. The tribal area of the 6th schedule falls outside the executive authority of the concerned state.
3. Governor can reorganize and alter the boundaries of autonomous districts under the schedule.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.43) Consider the following statements about autonomous districts under 6th schedule:

1. The elected and nominated members of autonomous districts hold term for 5 years
2. The district Council is empowered to collect revenue in autonomous districts under 6th schedule.
3. The laws made by district council administrators require assent of the Governor.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.44) Which one of the following Schedules to the Constitution of India provides for setting up of Autonomous District Councils?

- a) Third schedule
- b) Fourth schedule
- c) Fifth schedule
- d) Sixth schedule

Q.45) The provisions of the fifth schedule of the Constitution of India shall *not* apply to which of the following states?

1. Jharkhand and Arunachal Pradesh



2. Tripura and Meghalaya
3. Assam and Mizoram
4. Orissa and Manipur

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 4 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 and 4 only
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.46) With reference to Fifth Schedule of the constitution of India, consider the following statements:

1. The President of India has the power to declare a particular region as a scheduled area.
2. When required by the President, the Governor has to submit a report regarding the administration of such areas.
3. Each state with a scheduled area may or may not establish a Tribes Advisory Council to advise on the welfare and advancement of the scheduled tribes.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.47) "The office of this political entity is empowered to direct that any particular act of Parliament or the state legislature does not apply to a scheduled area. It can also make regulations for the peace and good government of a scheduled area after consulting the Tribes Advisory Council."

The entity referred to in the above statement is:

- a) Governor of the concerned state
- b) President of India
- c) Chief Minister of the concerned state
- d) Union Minister of Tribal Affairs

Q.48) Consider the following statements:

1. An amendment to the fifth and sixth schedules of the constitution would require the consent of the state legislatures.
2. The constitution requires the President to appoint a Commission to report on the administration of the scheduled areas.
3. The acts of Parliament or the State Legislature either do not apply to autonomous districts and autonomous regions or apply with specified modifications and exceptions.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only

- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.49) Consider the following statements.

1. The presiding officer can take up a defection case suo moto.
2. The presiding officer of a House is empowered to make rules to give effect to the provisions of the Tenth Schedule of the Constitution.

Which of the above statement is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.50) As per the Anti-defection provisions a member of either House of Parliament or either House of a State Legislature belonging to any political party who is disqualified on the ground of defection shall also be disqualified to

1. Vote or contest in elections
2. Be appointed as a Minister
3. Hold any remunerative political post

Select the correct Ans: using the codes below.

- a) 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1, 2 and 3
- d) 1 and 3 only

Q.51) Consider the following statements

1. The Ministers hold office during the pleasure of President
2. The advice tendered by Ministers to the President can be inquired into any court
3. The salaries, allowances of ministers shall be determined by the President

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.52) Consider the following statements

1. There is provision in Indian Constitution for the legal responsibility of a minister
2. Even after the dissolution of the Lok Sabha, the council of ministers does not cease to hold office



Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 and 2

Q.53) Consider the following statements regarding Cabinet

- 1. It is a smaller body and includes the cabinet ministers only
- 2. The word cabinet was inserted in Article 352 of the Constitution in 1978 by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act
- 3. It is an advisory body to the President and its advice is binding on him/her.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2
- b) 2 and 3
- c) 1 and 3
- d) 3 only

Q.54) Consider the following statements regarding State Council of Ministers

- 1. Every minister is entitled to vote even if he/she is not the member of that house.
- 2. All executive action of the State Government shall be expressed to be taken in the name of the Governor.
- 3. The Constitution does not specify exact size of the State Council of Ministers or the ranking of Ministers.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3
- b) 2 and 3
- c) 2 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.55) Consider the following statements regarding Parliamentary Secretaries

- 1. They often hold the rank of minister of state and are appointed by chief minister of the state concerned.
- 2. They have no department in their control and are attached to senior ministers.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 and 2

Q.56) Consider the following statements regarding Cabinet Secretariat.

- 1. It assists in decision making in government by ensuring inter-ministerial coordination and evolving consensus.
- 2. It is under the direct control of Home Minister.
- 3. The administrative head of the Secretariat is the Chief Secretary who is also the ex-officio Chairman of the Civil Services Board.

Which of the statement/s given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3
- c) 1 and 2
- d) 1 and 3

Q.57) Consider the following statements regarding Chief Secretary

- 1. It acts as the head of the state civil services
- 2. He/She is the administrative head of the Union Cabinet secretariat
- 3. It acts as the Principal advisor to Chief minister on all the matters of State Administration

Which of the statements above given is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2
- b) 1 only
- c) 1 and 3
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Q.58) Consider the following statements:

- 1. Post of Vice president of Indian Constitution has been taken from Canadian constitution
- 2. The resolution for removal of the Vice President can be introduced only in Rajya Sabha.
- 3. The resolution for removal of Vice President must be passed by effective majority in Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 1 and 2 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.59) Consider the following statements

- 1. The office of the governor and the manner of his appointment has been taken from Canadian constitution



2. He is entitled to such emoluments, allowances and privileges as may be determined by Parliament.
3. When the same person is appointed as the governor of two or more states, the emoluments and allowances payable to him are shared by the states in equal proportion

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 2 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 3 only

Q.60) Consider the following statements about Governor:

1. The Governor has been provided security of tenure of 5 years in the constitution.
2. The Governor has the power to appoint and remove members of the state information commission.
3. The Governor cannot pardon the death sentence of a prisoner.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 3 only
- d) 2 and 3 only

Q.61) Consider the following statements:

1. The number of judges of Supreme court and High court is decided by Parliament of India
2. There is no minimum age prescribed to be appointed as Judge of Supreme Court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.62) Consider the following statements

1. The constitution has provided for a maximum number of 10 judges in the High Court.
2. The jurisdiction of High Court regarding union territory is decided by the President of India
3. Disputes regarding election of Member of Parliament falls under its original jurisdiction of the high court.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) None of the above.

Q.63) Which of the following falls under original jurisdiction of high court:

1. Matters related to revenue collection.
2. Enforcement of fundamental rights of citizens
3. Cases ordered to be transferred from a subordinate court involving the interpretation of the Constitution.
4. Disputes relating to election of Panchayat members.

Select the correct option/s from the code given below

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1,2 and 3 only
- d) All of the above.

Q.64) Consider the following statements regarding anti defection law:

1. Disqualification on the ground of defection for a Member of Parliament will not apply if a two-third member goes out of his party as a result of a merger of the party with another party.
2. Presiding officer of the house decides the question of disqualification of a member of the house arising on the ground of defection
3. The decision of the presiding officer cannot be questioned in a court of law.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 1 and 2 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 2 only

Q.65) Consider the following statements

1. The Salary of the chief minister of a state is decided by an act of parliament.
2. The term of the chief minister is for 5 years.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above



Q.66) Consider the following statements about

Cabinet Secretary:

1. He is the ex-officio head of the Civil Services Board and the Cabinet Secretariat.
2. He Provides Secretarial assistance to the Cabinet and its Committees.
3. He evolves consensus through the instrumentality of the standing Committees of Secretaries.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.67) Consider the following statements

1. A cabinet secretary is appointed for a fixed tenure of two years.
2. The tenure of Cabinet Secretary cannot be extended beyond the term of one year after completion of fixed tenure.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.68) Consider the following statements

1. The total number of ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the Council of Ministers shall not exceed 10% of the total strength of the Lok Sabha.
2. A minister who is a member of one House of Parliament has the right to speak, to take part and vote in the other house.
3. A person who is not a member of either House of Parliament can also be appointed as a minister.

Which of the statements given above is/are incorrect?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 3 only
- d) None of the above

Q.69) Who of the following is/are part of union executive?

1. President
2. Vice president
3. All members of Council of Ministers
4. Advocate and Solicitor General

Select the correct option/s from the code given below:

- a) 1,3 and 4 only
- b) 1,2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) All of the above

Q.70) Consider the following statements:

1. The size of the council of ministers excluding the chief minister cannot exceed 15% of the total strength of the state legislative assembly.
2. The Governor has the right to address and send messages to the Council of Ministers

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Q.71) According to the "National Register of Large Dams, 2021" recently released by the Govt. of India, which of the following states has the highest number of 'Large Dams'?

- a) Maharashtra
- b) Madhya pradesh
- c) Gujrat
- d) Odisha

Q.72) If you are traveling from Chabahar to the Suez Canal via sea, which of the following water bodies will you encounter in your journey?

1. Gulf of Oman
2. Strait of Hormuz
3. Strait of Bab-el-Mandeb
4. Persian Gulf
5. Gulf of Aden

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,2,3 and 5 only
- b) 3,4 and 5 only
- c) 1,2and 4 only
- d) 1,3 and 5 only

Q.73) Which of the following sectors have been identified as strategic sectors under the recently unveiled Disinvestment Policy?

1. Atomic energy
2. Telecommunications
3. Financial Services
4. Petroleum
5. Defence



Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,2 and 3 only
- b) 1,4 and 5 only
- c) 2,3 and 5 only
- d) 1,2,3,4 and 5

Q.74) Consider the following rivers that join River Alaknanda to form various *Prayags* (confluences):

- 1. Dhauliganga
- 2. Mandakini
- 3. Pindar Ganga
- 4. Nandakini

The correct sequence of the above confluences from North to South is

- a) 1-4-3-2
- b) 1-3-4-2
- c) 1-2-4-3
- d) 3-2-1-4

Q.75) The *Global Risks Report* is published by

- a) World Bank
- b) International Monetary Fund
- c) World Economic Forum
- d) United Nations Environment Programme

Q.76) Which of the following fall within the ambit of the term "*Fiscal Conservatism*"?

- 1. High Tax rates
- 2. Free Trade
- 3. Encouraging Foreign Direct investment
- 4. Low Repo Rate
- 5. Privatization

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,2 and 5 only
- b) 2, 3 and 5 only
- c) 3,4 and 5 only
- d) 1,2,3 and 4 only

Q.77) The '*Rome Statute*', recently seen in the news, is related to

- a) International Criminal Court
- b) International Court of Justice
- c) Food and Agricultural Organization
- d) International Court of Arbitration

Q.78) "In India, the Information Technology Act, 2000 covers all 'intermediaries' who play a role in the use of computer resources and electronic records."

With reference to the above statement, the term "intermediaries" includes which of the following?

- 1. Telecom service provider
- 2. Internet service and web hosting provider
- 3. Cyber cafes
- 4. Search engines

Select the Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 and 4 only
- c) 1,2 and 4 only
- d) 1,2,3 and 4

Q.79) The geological features '*Main Central Thrust*' and '*Main boundary thrust*' are associated with

- a) The Himalayas
- b) The Western Ghats
- c) The Raajmahal-Garo Gap
- d) The Vindhya mountains

Q.80) Which of the following could be the possible advantages/ applications of the '*Indigen*' project for sequencing Indian genes?

- 1. Earlier detection of genetic predispositions to disease
- 2. Rational drug design and custom drugs
- 3. Genotyping of all viruses to direct appropriate treatment
- 4. Identification of mutations linked to different forms of cancer

Select the Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,2 and 4 only
- b) 2,3 and 4 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1,2,3 and 4

Q.81) The '*Justice Sri Krishna Committee Report*' sometimes seen in news, is related to

- a) Ecological aspects of the North Eastern Forests
- b) Data Protection Framework
- c) Sub-Categorization of the Other Backward Classes
- d) Fintech and Digital Payments

Q.82) With reference to the Goods and Services Tax Council (GST), consider the following statements:

- 1. According to the constitution, the Union Minister of State for Finance shall be the Vice-Chairperson of the Council
- 2. According to the constitution, One-half of the total number of Members of the GST Council shall constitute the quorum at its meetings.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only



- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.83) This UNESCO World heritage site in central India spans the prehistoric Paleolithic and Mesolithic periods and provides a "rare glimpse into human settlement and cultural evolution from hunter-gatherers, to agriculture, and expressions of prehistoric spirituality."

The ancient site, mentioned in the above excerpt, is

- a) Sanchi Stupa
- b) Udayagiri Caves
- c) Bhimbetka Caves
- d) Ellora Caves

Q.84) Consider the following statements:

1. In India, the price of Liquefied Petroleum Gas (LPG) is linked to the price in the International market.
2. In India, the price of fertilisers is not linked to the prices of various raw materials in the international market.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.85) "The Paris Call Agreement", sometimes seen in news, is associated with

- a) Cross Border Terrorism
- b) International Sleeper Cells
- c) Cybersecurity
- d) Lone Wolf Terrorism

Q.86) Which of the following Cabinet Committees is not headed by the Prime Minister ?

1. Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs
2. Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs
3. Appointments Committee of the Cabinet
4. Cabinet Committee on Accommodation
5. Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs.

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,3 and 5 only
- b) 1 and 4 only
- c) 2,4 and 5 only
- d) 4 only

Q.87) With Reference to FASTags in India, consider the following statements:

1. FASTags use Active Radio Frequency Identification Technology for seamless tolling operations.

2. They have been developed under the National Electronic Toll Collection (NETC) program by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI)
3. FASTag is vehicle specific and once affixed to a vehicle, it cannot be transferred to another vehicle.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 2 only
- d) 1,2 and 3

Q.88) In India, "the Consent to Establish" and "the Consent to Operate" are required under which of the following legislations?

- a) Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act, 2010
- b) Places of Worship (Special Provisions) Act, 1991
- c) Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1981
- d) National Commission for Minority Educational Institutions Act, 2004

Q.89) "Home to the famous Maldhari Tribes of Western India, these grasslands form a belt of arid grassland ecosystem on the outer southern edge of the desert of the marshy salt flats of Rann of Kutch. The Wildlife Institute of India has identified this grassland reserve as one of the last remaining habitats of the cheetah in India."

Identify the Grasslands mentioned in the above excerpt.

- a) Chauras
- b) Vidis
- c) Phumdis
- d) Banni

Q.90) With reference to the Rajya Sabha, consider the following statements:

1. In case of a vacancy in the seat of an elected member, the new member elected to fill that seat holds office for the remainder of the term of his predecessor.
2. In case of a vacancy in the seat of a nominated member, the new member nominated to fill that seat gets a full 6 year term.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.91) The Govt. of India recently announced a Production Linked incentive scheme for manufacturing of *white goods*. In this context, which of the following are categorized as "*white goods*" by economists?

1. Refrigerators
2. Washing machines
3. Pipes and Bathtubs
4. Air Conditioners
5. Television set
6. LED lights

Choose the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,2,4 and 6 only
- b) 1,2,5 and 6 only
- c) 3,4,5 and 6 only
- d) 1,2,4 and 5 only

Q.92) "*The Center for High Technology*", sometimes seen in the media, is a technical body under the purview of

- a) Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas
- b) Ministry of Earth Sciences
- c) Ministry of Defence
- d) Ministry of Science and Technology

Q.93) Which of the following most appropriately describes the "*FUJIWHARA EFFECT*"?

- a) A phenomenon that occurs when the Coriolis force equals the pressure gradient force.
- b) Seasonal Weakening of the Polar Vortex
- c) A phenomenon that occurs when two nearby cyclonic systems move around each other.
- d) Climatic Teleconnections associated with an abnormally strong El-Nino

Q.94) According to the Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005, Which of the following are functions of the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR)?

1. Study treaties and other international instruments and undertake periodic review of existing policies
2. Present annual reports on various safeguards for protection of child rights to the President
3. Undertake and promote research in the field of child rights
4. Take suo motu cognizance of matters relating to deprivation of child rights
5. Spread child rights literacy among various sections of society

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,3 and 4 only

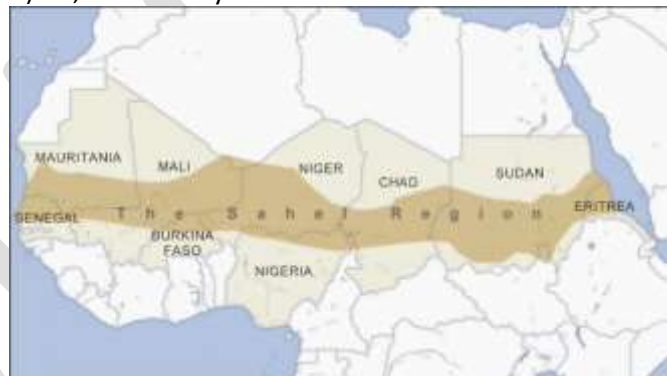
- b) 2 and 5 only
- c) 1,3,4 and 5 only
- d) 1,2,3,4 and 5

Q.95) Which of the following countries lie within the SAHEL region of Africa?

1. LIBYA
2. SUDAN
3. EGYPT
4. MALI
5. NIGERIA

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,3 and 5 only
- b) 2,4 and 5 only
- c) 3,4 and 5 only
- d) 1,2 and 3 only



Q.96) The *Artemis Accords*, sometimes seen in news, is related to

- a) Principles Governing the Activities of States in the Exploration of Deep Ocean Resources
- b) The Two state solution concerning Israel and Palestine
- c) Civil exploration and peaceful use of various astronomical objects
- d) Follow up action taken in accordance with principles of Paris Climate Agreement

Q.97) Which of the following are possible advantages of aquaponics?

1. Significant reduction in the usage of water is possible.
2. Significantly faster growth of plants is possible.
3. The system has no reliance on chemical fertilizer.
4. It is possible for the farmer to have multiple streams of Income.
5. It Eliminates the chances of soil borne diseases.

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 1,2 and 4 only
- b) 1,2,4 and 5 only
- c) 3 and 5 only
- d) 1,2,3,4 and 5



Q.98) With reference to the Code on Social Security, 2020, consider the following statements:

1. Under the Code, the provision of maternity benefit has been made universal.
2. The Code contains provisions for extending social security to gig workers and platform workers.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) None of the above

Q.99) The rare earth minerals have been touted to play a big role in the global push for green energy. In this context, which of the following elements are considered as Rare Earth Elements?

1. Monazite
2. Neodymium
3. Samarium
4. Gadolinium
5. Thorium
6. Lutetium
7. Yttrium

Select the correct Ans: using the code given below:

- a) 2,3,4,5 and 6 only
- b) 2,3,4,6 and 7 only
- c) 1,5,6 and 7 only
- d) 1,2,3,4,5,6 and 7

Q.100) Katarni Rice and Jardalu Mango, recently seen in news, are few of the agricultural products to get GI certification from the state of

- a) Uttar Pradesh
- b) Madhya Pradesh
- c) Bihar
- d) Jharkhand

Q.1) Ans: C

Exp:

The veto power enjoyed by the executive in modern states can be classified into the following four types:

1. Absolute veto: withholding of assent to the bill passed by the legislature.
2. Qualified veto: which can be overridden by the legislature with a higher majority.
3. Suspensive veto: which can be overridden by the legislature with an ordinary majority.
4. Pocket veto: that is, taking no action on the bill passed by the legislature.

Of the above four, **the President of India is vested with three—absolute veto, suspensive veto and pocket veto.** There is no qualified veto in the case of Indian President; it is possessed by the American President.

The three vetoes of the President of India are explained below:

Absolute Veto

It refers to the power of the President to withhold his assent to a bill passed by the Parliament. The bill then ends and does not become an act. Usually, this veto is exercised in the following two cases:

- (a) With respect to private members' bills
- (b) With respect to the government bills when the cabinet resigns (after the passage of the bills but before the assent by the President) and the new cabinet advises the President not to give his assent to such bills.

Suspensive Veto

The President exercises this veto when he returns a bill for reconsideration of the Parliament. However, if the bill is passed again by the Parliament with or without amendments and again presented to the President, it is obligatory for the President to give his assent to the bill.

Pocket Veto

In this case, the President neither ratifies nor rejects nor returns the bill, but simply keeps the bill pending for an indefinite period. This power of the President not to take any action (either positive or negative) on



the bill is known as the pocket veto. The President can exercise this veto power as the

The Constitution does not prescribe any time-limit within which he has to take the decision with respect to a bill presented to him for his assent.

Q.2) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is Incorrect: He decides on questions as to disqualifications of members of the Parliament, in consultation **with the Election Commission not Speaker.**

Statement 2 is Incorrect: The President can seek advice from the Supreme Court on any question of law or fact. However, the advice tendered by the Supreme Court is **not binding on the President.**

Statement 3 is Correct: The President has no veto power in respect of a Constitutional Amendment bill. **The 24th Constitutional Amendment Act of 1971 made it obligatory for the President to give his assent to a constitutional amendment bill.**

Q.3) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The resolution for the impeachment of the President is moved after 14 days' notice but it should be signed by not less than one-fourth members of the House. After the impeachment resolution is passed by a majority of two-third of the total membership of that House, it is sent to another House, which should investigate the charge.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The president of India can be removed from office by a process of impeachment for 'violation of the Constitution'. However, the Constitution does not define the meaning of the phrase 'violation of the Constitution'. Other than this he can also vacate his office by resignation in writing under his hand addressed to the Vice-President.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH, D.D. BASU

Q.4) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** When the vacancy is going to be created by the expiration of the term of sitting President, an election to fill the vacancy must be completed before expiration of the term. In case of any delay in the election, the outgoing President continues to hold the office until his successor assumes the office.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** In order to prevent 'interregnum', owing to any possible delay in conducting the election of a new President by any reason, it is provided that the outgoing President must continue to hold office, notwithstanding that his term has expired, until his successor enters upon his office.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Vice-President cannot act as the President after the expiration of the term of the sitting President, as the outgoing President continues to hold office until his successor enters upon his office after a fresh election.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH, D.D. BASU

Q.5) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The President cannot promulgate ordinance when both Houses are in session. The legislative power of Parliament is superior and simultaneously the President cannot promulgate ordinance, hence the power of President to legislate by ordinance is not parallel to the power of legislation
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The President can promulgate ordinance only when both the Houses of Parliament are not in session or when either of the House is not in session or one House is in session. An ordinance made when both the Houses are in session is void.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The President makes an ordinance when he is satisfied that such circumstance does exist to take immediate action. Thus the satisfaction of the President is important in making an ordinance.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** In the Cooper case (1970), the Supreme Court held that the President's satisfaction can be questioned in a court on the ground of malafide.

Sources: M. LAXMIKANTH, D.D. BASU

Q.6) Ans: B



Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As per Article 71 (a), all the disputes and doubts in connection with election of President or Vice-President are enquired into and by the Supreme Court whose decision is exclusive and final.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Election of the Vice president cannot be challenged on the ground of any vacancy in the Electoral College which elected the Vice-President. Also if the election of the Vice-President is declared void by the Supreme Court, acts done by him prior to the date of such decision of the Supreme Court shall not be invalidated.
- **Statement 3 is correct and statement 4 incorrect:** Although Indian Vice-President is modeled on the lines of American Vice-President, there is a difference. The American Vice-President succeeds to the presidency when it falls vacant, and remains President for the unexpired term of his predecessor. The Indian Vice-President, on the other hand, does not assume the office of the President when it falls vacant for the unexpired term. He merely serves as an acting President until the new President is elected

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH, D.D. BASU

Q.7) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The electoral college of Vice-President consists of both elected and nominated members of the parliament (in case of President, only elected members).
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** It does not include the members of state legislative assemblies. The President is the head of the State and his power extends both to the administration by Centre as well as states. Consequently, it is necessary that in his election, not only members of Parliament should play their part, but the members of the state legislatures should have a voice.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The electoral college of Vice-President does not consist of Union Territory of Delhi and Puducherry (in case of President, elected members of legislative assemblies of State and Union Territory of Delhi and Puducherry are included).

Source: D.D. BASU, M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.8) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Constitution does not contain any specific procedure for the selection and appointment of the Prime Minister. Article 75 says only that the Prime Minister shall be appointed by the President but does not describe any procedure.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The term of Prime Minister is not fixed and he holds office during the pleasure of the President. However, it does not mean that the President can dismiss the Prime Minister at any time. If The Prime Minister enjoys the majority support in the Lok Sabha, he/she cannot be dismissed by the President.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The Prime Minister as the head of the Union council of ministers, hence he/she can bring about the collapse of the council of ministers by resigning from office.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** The Prime Minister as the leader of the Lower House, in this capacity he/she can recommend the dissolution of the Lok Sabha to the President at any time.

Source: D.D. BASU, M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.9) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Prime Minister is the leader of the Lower House in this capacity he advises the President with regard to summoning and proroguing of the sessions of the Parliament.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** As the leader of the Lower House Prime minister announces policies of the government on the floor of the House.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** This power of the **Prime Minister is in relation with the President**, in which he acts as a communication channel between the President and the council of ministers.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** This power is also in **relation with the President**, the Prime Minister communicates to the President all decisions of the council of ministers relating to the administration of the affairs of the union and proposals of the legislation.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.10) Ans: C

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is correct:** Article 72 of the Constitution empowers the President to grant pardons, the objective of conferring this power to the President is to keep the door open for correcting any judicial errors in the operation of law.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The pardoning power of the President is not similar to the pardoning power of the Governor, as the President can pardon even a death sentence and also any punishment or sentence by a court-martial but, the Governor cannot do so, the pardoning power of the Governor cannot extend beyond the punishment or sentence prescribe to a person against a state law.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Through pardoning the President also affords relief from a sentence, which the President regards as unduly harsh.
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** President exercises pardoning power on the advice of the **Union Cabinet**.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.11) Ans: A

Exp:

- The pardoning power of the President includes **Pardon, Commutation, Remission, Respite and Reprieve**. Article 72 empowers the President to grant pardons to persons who have been tried and convicted in all the cases like, punishment or sentence against a Union Law, punishment or sentence by a court martial and sentence is a sentence of death.
- **Option A matches with option 1: Pardon:-** It removes both the sentence and the conviction and completely absolves the convict from all sentences, punishment and disqualifications.
- **Option B matches with option 5: Commutation:-** It denotes the substitution of one form of punishment for a lighter form. For example, a death sentence may be commuted to rigorous imprisonment.
- **Option C matches with option 3: Remission:-** It implies reducing the period of sentence without changing its character. For example, a sentence rigorous imprisonment for two years may be remitted to rigorous imprisonment for one year.
- **Option D matches with option 2: Respite:-** It denotes awarding a lesser sentence in place of one

originally awarded due to some special fact, such as physical disability of a convict or the pregnancy of a woman.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.12) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is Incorrect: The Discretionary powers exercised by the Governor is not beyond Judicial review. The Supreme Court, speaking through a five-judge Bench in **Nabam Rebia and Bamang Felix v. Deputy Speaker (2016)** ruled that the **discretionary power of the Governor is extremely limited and entirely amenable to judicial review**.

Statement 2 is Incorrect: As the money bill is introduced with the Governor's permission, he cannot return the money bill for the reconsideration of the State Legislature. He can either give his assent, withhold his assent or reserve the bill for consideration of the president.

Source: <https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/op-ed/governors-discretion/article25021561.ece>

Q.13) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is Incorrect: Usually, there is a governor for each state, but the 7th Constitutional Amendment Act of 1956 facilitated the appointment of the same person as a governor for two or more states.

Statement 2 is Incorrect: Supreme Court in 1979, the office of governor of a state is not an employment under the Central government. It is an independent constitutional office and **is not under the control** of or subordinate to the Central government

Statement 3 is Incorrect: The **oath of office to the Governor is administered by the Chief justice of the concerned state high court** and in his absence, the senior-most judge of that court available (not the President)

Statement 4 is Correct: The Governor appoints the chairman and members of the State public service commission. However, **they can be removed only by the president and not by a governor**.



Source: M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.14) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The President may make such provision as he thinks fit for the discharge of the functions of the governor in any contingency not provided in the Constitution, for example, the death of a sitting governor. Thus, the chief justice of the concerned state can be appointed temporarily as the governor of that state.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The constitution does not lay down any grounds upon which the governor may be removed by the President. The President can transfer a Governor from one state to another state for the rest of the term.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** A Governor holds office for a term of five years from the date on which he enters upon his office. However, his term is subject to the pleasure of the President but, the Supreme Court held that the pleasure of the President is **not Justifiable**.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.15) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Governor can grant pardons, reprieves, respite and remissions of punishment or suspend, remit and commute the sentence of any person convicted of any offence against any law but, law relating to a matter to which the executive power of the state extends and not outside the jurisdiction of the state executive power.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** While appointing the judges of the high court of the concerned state the governor of that state is consulted by the President. The persons of the state judicial service (other than district judges) are also appointed by the Governor in consultation with the state high court and the State Public Service Commission.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** He cannot pardon a death sentence. Even if a state law prescribes for the death sentence, the power to grant pardon lies with the President and not with the governor. But, the governor can suspend, remit or commute a death sentence.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** All the appointments, postings and promotions of the district judges are done in consultation with the state high court.

Q.16) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The discretionary power of the Governor is greater than the discretionary power of the President, as the President has only situational discretion and not constitutional discretion, while the Governor has both the discretion powers, for example he can use situational discretion to appoint the Chief Minister when no party has a clear-cut majority (same in case of the President). Some constitutional discretion are reservation of bills for consideration of the president, seeking information from the chief minister with regard to administrative and legislative matters of state.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Governor has both situational as well as constitutional discretion, while the President has only situational discretion.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH, D.D. BASU

Q.17) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Governor is empowered to organize and reorganize the autonomous districts. Thus, he can increase or decrease their areas or change their names or define their boundaries and so on.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Governor is empowered to divide the autonomous district into several autonomous regions, if different tribes are present in the autonomous district.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The power to declare an area to be scheduled area lies with the President and not the Governor.
- **Statement 4 is correct:** The Governor is empowered to appoint a commission to examine and report on any matter relating to the administration of the autonomous districts or regions. He may also dissolve a district or regional council on recommendation of the commission.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.18) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** As the head of the state council of ministers the Chief Minister can allocate the portfolios among the ministers.



- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Chief Minister can bring about the collapse of the council of ministers by resigning from office. Since the Chief Minister is the head of the council of the ministers, his resignation or death automatically dissolves the council of ministers.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** It is In relation to the Governor he/she communicates to the governor of the state all the decisions of the council of the ministers relating to the administration of the affairs of the state and proposals or legislation
- **Statement 4 is incorrect:** As the leader of the house, the Chief Minister can announce the government policies on the floor of the house. This power of the Chief Minister is in relation with the State Legislature and not with the Council of Ministers.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH

Q.19) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Article 163, states that there shall be a council of ministers with the Chief Minister as the head to aid and advise the Governor on the exercise of his functions, except insofar as he is required to exercise his functions or any of them at his discretion.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** Article 167, states that it shall be the duty of the Chief Minister to communicate to the Governor of the state all decisions of the council of ministers relating to the administration of the affairs of the state and proposals for legislation and to furnish such information relating to the administration of the affairs of the state and proposals for legislation as the Governor may call for.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Council of Ministers shall be collectively responsible to the Legislative Assembly of the State. The ministers are jointly and severally responsible to the Legislature. He or they, is or are, publicly accountable for the acts or conducts in the performance of duties.

Source: M. LAXMIKANTH, D.D. BASU

Q.20) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The governor is an integral part of the state legislature. In that capacity, he can appoint any member of the state legislative assembly to preside over proceedings when the offices of both the Speaker and the Deputy Speaker fall vacant. Similarly, he can appoint any member of the state legislative council to preside over its proceedings when the offices of both Chairman and the Deputy Chairman fall vacant.

Statement 2 is correct: Article 192 (Decision on question as to disqualifications of members)

1. If any question arises as to whether a member of a House of the Legislature of a State has become subject to any of the disqualifications mentioned in **article 191**, the question shall be referred for the decision of the Governor and his decision shall be final.
2. Before giving any decision on any such question, the Governor shall obtain the opinion of the Election Commission and shall act according to such opinion.

Q.21) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** For ensuring the independence of the Supreme Court it is bestowed with the power to punish for its contempt. The Supreme Court can punish any person for its contempt. Its action and decisions cannot be criticized and opposed by anybody. The Contempt of Court may be civil or criminal. However, reasonable criticism of the judiciary act does not amount to contempt of court.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The jurisdiction of the Supreme Court cannot be curtailed. The Parliament is not authorised to curtail the jurisdiction and powers of the Supreme Court. However, the Parliament can extend the same.
- **Statement 3 incorrect:** Article 143 of the Constitution of India confers upon the Supreme Court advisory jurisdiction. The president can seek the opinion of the Supreme Court in the two categories of matters- on the question of law fact of public importance and on any dispute arising out of any pre constitutional agreement treaty etc or other similar instruments.

Q.22) Ans: D

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The writ jurisdiction of the Supreme Court is not exclusive. The high courts are also empowered to issue writs for the enforcement of fundamental rights. Each High Court has power to issue to any person within its jurisdiction directions/ writs for enforcement of Fundamental Rights and for any other purpose.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** An aggrieved person can directly go to the Supreme Court for the enforcement of the fundamental rights in this scenario the Supreme Court has original jurisdiction'. Therefore, there is no need for an aggrieved person to compulsorily approach the High Court first for the enforcement of the Fundamental rights.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Article 32 of the Indian Constitution empowers the Supreme Court to issue writs to enforce only the fundamental rights against a person or government throughout the territory of India. Whereas, Article 226 empowers the High Courts of India to issue writs for the enforcement of the fundamental rights as well as for other purposes like the enforcement of an ordinary legal right. High courts can issue writs against a person residing, government or authority located within its territorial jurisdiction Or Outside its territorial jurisdiction if the cause of action arises within its territorial jurisdiction.

Q.23) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** Certiorari means to 'certify'. Certiorari is issued by a Higher Court to a Lower court / Tribunal to transfer a case pending with the latter to itself or to squash the order of the latter in a case. It is issued on the grounds of excess of Jurisdiction or lack of Jurisdiction or error of law.
- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** Mandamus is issued by a court to the public official asking him to perform his official duties; it is in the nature of a command. It can also be issued against any public body and inferior Court.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** Habeas Corpus writ is used to release a person who has been unlawfully detained or imprisoned. The Court directs the person so detained to be brought before it to examine the legality of his detention. If the Court concludes that the detention was unlawful, then it directs the person to be released immediately.

Q.24) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Judges of the High Court are appointed by the president. The chief justice is appointed by the president after consultation with the Chief Justice of India and the governor of the state concerned. For the appointment of other judges, the president also consults the Chief Justice of the concerned High Court.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The constitution has not prescribed a minimum age for appointment as judge of high court. There are some qualifications required for a person to be appointed as the Judge of the High Court-
- **Statement 3 is correct:** A judge of high court can be removed from his office by an order of the president; the president can issue the removal order only after an address by the Parliament has been presented to him in the same session for such removal. The President of India can remove a Judge of the High Court, from his office only if each house of the parliament passes a resolution by a special majority of its members in each house requesting him to remove the judge.

Q.25) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The 42nd amendment act of 1976 curtailed the Judicial review power of the High Court. It debarred the high court from considering the constitutional validity of any Central law. But the 43rd Amendment Act of 1977 restored the original position.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** In addition to the appellate jurisdiction and supervisory jurisdiction over the subordinate courts, the High Court has administrative control over them too. Its laws are binding on all subordinate courts functioning within its territorial jurisdiction in the same sense as the law declared by the supreme court is binding on all Courts in India.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** As a court of record, the high court has the power to review and correct its own judgement / order / decision **even though in this case no specific power of review is conferred on the high courts by the constitution.**



Q.26) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** the Parliament can extend the jurisdiction of the High Court to any Union Territory or exclude the jurisdiction of the High Court from any union territory.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The salaries and allowances of the judges, the salaries allowances and pensions of the staff as well as administrative expenses of the High Court are charged to the consolidated fund of the state. However, the pension of a High Court judge is charged on the consolidated fund of India.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** In Chandra Kumar case 1997, the Supreme Court ruled that the writ jurisdiction of both the High Court under article 226 and that of the supreme court under article 32 Constitutes a part of the basic structure of the constitution.

Q.27) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Option 1 is correct:** Article 226 of the Constitution empowers a high court to issue writs including habeas corpus, mandamus, certiorari, prohibition and quo warranto for the enforcement of the fundamental rights of the citizens and for any other purpose.
- **Option 2 is correct:** Disputes relating to election of members of parliament are under original jurisdiction of the high court. Further **Article 323 B** empowers the appropriate legislature (Parliament or a state legislature) to establish a tribunal for the adjudication of election disputes.
- **Option 3 is correct:** Contempt of court also comes under original jurisdiction of high court. In India, the contempt law is mainly governed by the Contempt of Courts Act, 1971 as it empowers the court to punish acts of contempt because of which the Supreme Court and High Courts, by the virtue of being courts of record hold inherent jurisdiction to punish for contempt of court.

Q.28) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The collegium system has its genesis in a series of Supreme Court judgments called the 'Judges Cases' not directly mentioned in constitution. The Collegium System

is that under which appointments and promotion and transfer of the judges of the Supreme Court are decided by a forum which consists of the Chief Justice of India plus four of the senior-most judges of the Supreme Court.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** When there is a lack of quorum of the permanent judges to hold or continue any session of the Supreme Court, the Chief Justice of India can appoint a judge of a High Court as an ad hoc judge of the Supreme Court for a temporary period. He can do so only after consultation with the Chief Justice of the High Court concerned and with the previous consent of the president. The judge so appointed should be qualified for appointment as a judge of the Supreme Court.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Master of Roster refers to the privilege of the Chief Justice to constitute Benches to hear cases. No Judge can take up the matter on this own, unless allocated by the Chief Justice of India, as he is the master of the roster."

Q.29) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** A High court has the power of superintendence over all courts and tribunals functioning in its territorial jurisdiction (except military courts or tribunals)
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** As a court of record a high court also has the power to review and correct judgement or order or decision, even though **no specific** power of review is conferred on it by the constitution. The SC on the other hand has been specifically conferred with the power of review by the constitution.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Judicial review is the power of a high court to examine the constitutionality of legislative enactments and executive orders of both central and state governments.

Extraedge by Onlyias

The phrase 'Judicial review' has nowhere been used in the constitution, the provisions of Articles 13 and 226 explicitly confer the power of judicial review on a High Court.

Source of reference Polity Laxmikant

Q.30) Ans: B



EXP:

Statement 1 is incorrect The salaries, allowances, privileges, leave of the judges of a high court are determined from time to time by the Parliament. salaries, allowances of the high court judges are charged on the consolidated fund of state and are non-votable by the state legislature. It should be noted here that the pension of a high court judge is charged on the consolidated fund of India and not the state.

Statement 2 is correct The Constitution does not contain detailed provisions with regard to the jurisdiction and the powers of a high court. It only lays down that the jurisdiction and powers of a high court are to be the same as immediately before the commencement of the Constitution.

Source of reference Polity Laxmikant

Q.31) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct The appointment, posting and the promotion of the district judges in the state are made by the Governor of the state in consultation with the high court. A person to be appointed as a district judge should not be already in the service of the central and state government

Statement 2 is incorrect For eligibility he/she should have been an advocate or a pleader for seven years and not 10 years

Statement 3 is incorrect He/she should be recommended by the high court for appointment and not SC

Extra edge by Onlyias

Appointment of persons (other than district judges) to the judicial services of a state are made by the governor of the state after consultation with the state public service commission and the high court

Source of reference Laxmikant , DD basu

Q.32) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The President can transfer a judge from one high court to another after consulting the Chief Justice of India (not Governor). In third judge case supreme court said that in case of transfer of high court judges, the chief justice of India should consult, in addition to

the collegium of the four senior most judges of supreme court, the chief justice of the two concerned high court. On transfer he is entitled to receive in addition to his salary such compensatory allowance as may be determined by Parliament.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** In 1994 the SC held that judicial review is necessary to check arbitrariness in transfer of judges but only the judge who is transferred can challenge it.

Q.33) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect** The constitution of India provides for a high court for each state , but the seventh amendment act of 1956 authorised the Parliament to establish a common high court for two or more states or for two or more states and a Union territory.
- **Statement 2 is correct** The Parliament can extend the jurisdiction of a high court to any union territory or exclude the jurisdiction of a high court from any union territory.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** A person appointed as a judge of a high court , before entering upon his office, has to make and subscribe an oath or affirmation before the Governor of the state or some person appointed by him for this purpose.

Source of reference Laxmikant

Q.34) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct.** A High court is primarily a court of appeal. It hears appeals against the judgements of subordinate courts functioning in its territorial jurisdiction. It has appellate jurisdiction in both civil and criminal matters. Hence the appellate jurisdiction of a high court is wider than its original jurisdiction.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Judicial review is the power of a high court to examine the constitutionality of legislative and executive orders of both the central and state governments. Though the phrase 'judicial review' has nowhere used in the constitution, the provisions of Articles 13 and 226 explicitly confer the power of judicial review on a high court.



Extra edge by Onlyias

Like the Supreme court, the high court has been vested with quite extensive and effective powers. It is the highest court of appeal in the state. At present a HC enjoys the jurisdiction and powers some of which includes : original jurisdiction, writ jurisdiction, appellate jurisdiction, a court of record, power of judicial review.

Q.35) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The 91st amendment to the constitution added **article 75 (1A)** according to which the total number of Ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the Council of Ministers shall not **exceed fifteen per cent** of the total number of members of the **House of the People**.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The amendment also added **article 75 (1B)** according to which a member of either House of Parliament belonging to any political party who is disqualified for being a member of that House under the **Tenth Schedule** shall also be **disqualified** to be appointed as a **Minister**.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The 91st amendment also added **article 361B** according to which a member of a House belonging to any political party who is disqualified for being a member of the House under the **Tenth Schedule** shall also be **disqualified to hold any remunerative political post**.
 - The expression **"remunerative political post"** means any office—
 - under the Government of India (State) where the salary or remuneration for such office is paid out of the public revenue of the Government of India (State)
 - under a body, whether incorporated or not, which is wholly or partially owned by the Government of India (State) and the salary or remuneration for such office is paid by such body, except where such salary or remuneration paid is compensatory in nature.

Q.36) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** It is the **presiding officer** (chairman or speaker, as the case may be) of a house who is **empowered to make rules** to give effect to the provisions of the tenth schedule. All such rules must be placed before the house for 30 days. The house may approve or modify or disapprove them further. The presiding officer may **also direct that any wilful contravention** by any member of such rules may be dealt with in the **same manner as a breach of privilege of the house**.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** According to the rules made, **the presiding officer can take a defection case only when he receives a complaint from a member of the house**. Before taking the final decision, she must give the member a chance to submit an Exp. She may also refer the matter to the **committee of privileges** for enquiry.
- **Statement 3 is Correct:** The anti defection act empowers the **presiding officer of the house (chairman or the speaker)** to decide on any question regarding the disqualification of a member arising out of defection. **Originally** the act provided that the decision of the presiding officer is final and cannot be questioned in any Court.
 - However, The Supreme court, in the **Kihoto Hollohan versus Zachillhu case (1992)**, observed that the suspicion of bias on the Speaker's role could not be ruled out. It hence **declared this provision unconstitutional** on the ground that it seeks to **take away the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and the high courts**. The decision of the presiding officer is **thus subject to judicial review**.

Q.37)

Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Cabinet Secretary is the top-most executive official and senior-most civil servant of the Government of India. She/he is the ex-officio head of the Civil Services Board and all civil services under the rules of business of the



government. She/he is the senior-most cadre post of the Indian Administrative Service.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** She/He ranks on the same level as the Attorney General of India in the order of precedence. Both are in the 11th rank in the table of precedence is - The Attorney General of India, Cabinet Secretary, Lieutenant governors with their respective union territories.
- **Statement is correct:** A cabinet Secretary is appointed for a fixed tenure of two years. The central government may give an extension in service for a further period not exceeding three months, beyond the period of four years to a cabinet secretary.

Q.38) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Chief- Secretary acts as an advisor to the CM. He/ She acts as a secretary to the state cabinet. Chief Secretary is the administrative head of the cabinet secretariat and attends the meeting of the cabinet and its sub-committees.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The chief secretary also acts as the residual legatee which means he looks after all those matters which do not fall within the purview of other secretaries.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The civil services board is headed by the Chief Secretary of a state and the board has senior most additional chief secretary or chairman, Board of Revenue, Financial Commissioner or an officer of equivalent rank and status as member.

Q.39) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** In 1971, the Supreme Court held that even after the dissolution of the Lok Sabha, the Council of Ministers does not cease to hold office. Hence, even when the Lok Sabha is dissolved, the President continues to work as per the aid and advice of previous council of ministers till the new COM assumes office
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The cabinet is an advisory body and a part of the Council of Minister it directs the Council of Ministers by taking policy decisions which are binding on all

ministers. It exercises control over hire appointments like constitution authorities and senior Secretariat administrators.

- **Statement 3 is correct:** Article 74(1) states that there shall be a Council of Ministers with a Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President. However, the president may require the Council of Ministers to reconsider such advice and the president shall act in accordance with the advice tendered after such reconsideration.

Q.40) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Pair 1 is correct:** The principle of collective responsibility finds a place in Art. 75(3). It is the duty of every minister to stand by cabinet decisions and support them both within and outside the parliament. This also means that the entire Council of ministers is a team that sinks or swims together. So if the Lok Sabha passes a no confidence motion against the Council of ministers then all have to resign.
- **Pair 2 is incorrect:** There is no such thing as the Parliamentary Responsibility of Ministers where the Duty of the Ministers to hold the Parliament sessions diligently.
- **Pair 3 is correct:** Article 75 and Article 164 contains the principle of individual responsibility. It states that the Ministers hold office during the pleasure of the president / Governor .

Q.41) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The Fifth Schedule of the Constitution deals with the administration of Scheduled Areas and Scheduled Tribes residing in any State other than the States of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram. The **President is empowered** to declare an area to be a scheduled area.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The **President** can increase or decrease its area or **change its boundary lines** or make fresh orders for such re-designation on an area in consultation with the governor of the state concerned.



Statement 3 is incorrect: Each state having scheduled areas has to establish a tribes advisory council to advise on welfare and advancement of the scheduled tribes. A **similar council can also be established in a state having scheduled tribes but not scheduled areas** if the president so directs.

Source: Laxmikanth

Q.42) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Constitution, under Sixth Schedule, contains special provisions for the administration of tribal areas in the four north-eastern states of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The tribal areas in the four states of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram have been constituted as autonomous districts. District and regional councils can make laws on certain specified matters like land, forests, canal water, shifting cultivation, village administration, inheritance of property, marriage and divorce and social customs. But **they do not fall outside the executive authority of the state concerned.**

Statement 3 is correct: The governor is empowered to organise and re-organise the autonomous districts. Thus, he can increase or decrease their areas or change their names or define their boundaries and so on.

Q.43) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: Each autonomous district has a district council consisting of 30 members, of whom four are nominated by the governor and the remaining 26 are elected on the basis of adult franchise. The elected members hold office for a term of five years (unless the council is dissolved earlier) and **nominated members hold office during the pleasure of the governor.**

Statement 2 is correct: The autonomous district is empowered to assess and collect land revenue and to impose certain specified taxes. Similar Powers are also available with regional councils.

Statement 3 is correct: The district and regional councils administer the areas under their jurisdiction. They can make laws on certain specified matters like land, forests, canal water, shifting cultivation, village administration, and inheritance of property, marriage and divorce, social customs. But all such laws require the assent of the governor.

Source: Laxmikanth

Reference question: Question on use of minor minerals under 6th schedule

Q.44) Ans: D

Exp:

Autonomous District councils:

- As per the **Sixth Schedule**, the four states viz. **Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram** contain the Tribal Areas which are **technically different from the Scheduled Areas** (5th Schedule).
- Though these areas fall within the **executive authority of the state**, provision has been made for the **creation of the District Councils and regional councils** for the exercise of the certain legislative and judicial powers.
- The Governor is empowered to :
 - Organise or Reorganise any area of autonomous district.
 - increase the area of any autonomous district
 - diminish the area of any autonomous district.
 - alter the name of any autonomous district.
 - define the boundaries of any autonomous district.

Q.45) Ans: B

Exp:

Fifth schedule of the Indian Constitution:

- According to article 244 of part X of the constitution, the provisions of the Fifth Schedule shall apply to the administration and control of the Scheduled Areas and Scheduled Tribes in any State **other than** the States of **Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram.**
- The **Philosophy** behind the schedule areas is that they are **inhabited by aboriginals who are socially and economically backward** and hence special efforts need to be made to improve their condition. Therefore the **whole of the normal**

administrative machinery operating in the state is not extended to the schedule areas and the central government has somewhat greater responsibility for this area

of money-lending in relation to the scheduled tribes.

- Also, a regulation may repeal or amend any act of Parliament or the state legislature, which is applicable to a scheduled area. But, all such regulations require the assent of the president.

Q.46) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The president is empowered to declare an area to be a scheduled area. He can also increase or decrease its area, alter its boundary lines, rescind such designation or make fresh orders for such re-designation on area in consultation with the governor of the state concerned.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The executive power of a state extends to the scheduled areas therein. But the governor has a special responsibility regarding such areas. He has to submit a report to the president regarding the administration of such areas, annually or whenever so required by the president. The executive power of the Centre extends to giving directions to the states regarding the administration of such areas.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Each state having a scheduled area has to Mandatorily establish the tribes Advisory Council to advise on welfare and advancement of the scheduled tribes. It consists of 20 members, three-fourth of whom are to be the representatives of the scheduled tribes in the state legislative assembly. A similar Council can also be established in a state having Scheduled Tribes, but not schedule areas therein, if the president so directs.

Q.47) Ans: A

Exp:

Governor and the Fifth schedule:

- The governor can direct that any particular act of Parliament or the state legislature does not apply to a scheduled area or apply with specified modifications and exceptions.
- He/she can also make regulations for the peace and good government of a scheduled area after consulting the tribes advisory council. Such regulations may prohibit or restrict the transfer of land by or among members of the scheduled tribes, regulate the allotment of land to members of the scheduled tribes and regulate the business

Q.48) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Provisions related to administration of the scheduled tribes (Fifth Schedule and Sixth Schedule of the Indian Constitution) can be subjected to changes and amendments by a simple majority of the Parliament and hence do not require the consent of the state legislature
- **Statement 2 is correct:** According to article 339 of the Constitution of India, The President may at any time appoint a Commission to report on the administration of the Scheduled Areas and the welfare of the Scheduled Tribes in the States. Hence, a commission was appointed in 1960. It was headed by U.N.Dhebar and submitted its report in 1961. After four decades, the second commission was appointed in 2002 under the chairmanship of Dilip Singh Bhuria. It submitted its report in 2004
- **Statement 3 is correct:** The acts of Parliament or the state legislature do not apply to autonomous districts and autonomous regions or apply with specified modifications and exceptions. The power of direction, in this regard, lies either with the president or governor. Thus, in the case of Assam, it lies with the Governor, both in respect of acts of Parliament or state legislature. In the case of Meghalaya, Tripura and Mizoram, it lies with the president in respect of acts of Parliament and governor in respect of acts of state legislature.

Q.49) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: the presiding officer can take up a defection case only when he receives a complaint from a member of the House. Before taking the final decision, he must give the member (against whom the complaint has been made) a chance to submit his Exp. He may also refer the matter to the committee of privileges for inquiry. Hence, defection has no



immediate and automatic effect. Decision of the Presiding officer is subject to Judicial review

Statement 2 is correct: The presiding officer of a House is empowered to make rules to give effect to the provisions of the Tenth Schedule (provisions for anti-defection)

Q.50) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: Disqualification will not bar a member from contesting any future election during the remaining period of the house.

Statement 2 is correct: As per provision added by 91st amendment act a member of either house of Parliament belonging to any political party who is disqualified on the ground of defection shall also be disqualified to be appointed as a minister.

Statement 3 is correct: He shall also be disqualified to hold any remunerative political post.

Q.51) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Prime minister is appointed by the President and others ministers are appointed by the president on the advice of the PM. The ministers hold office during the pleasure of the president and they are collectively responsible to the Lok sabha.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect** In Article 74 constitution mentions that council of ministers to aid and advise the president. The advice tendered by the ministers to the president shall not be inquired into any court.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect** The salaries and allowances of ministers are determined by the Parliament (and not by the President) from time to time and they receive the salaries and allowances that are payable to a member of Parliament.

Extraedge by Onlyias

The Principle of collective responsibility as mentioned in Article 75(CoM) is collectively

responsible to Lok Sabha) forms the bedrock of the Parliamentary system of government.

Source of reference Polity Laxmikant

Q.52) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect** In Britain, every order of the King for any public act is countersigned by a minister. The minister would be held responsible and would be liable in the court if the order is in violation of any law. In India, on the other hand, there are no provisions in the constitution for the system of legal responsibility of a minister.
- **Statement 2 is correct.** In 1971, the Supreme Court held that even after the dissolution of Lok Sabha the council of ministers does not cease to hold office. Article 74 is mandatory and therefore, the president cannot exercise the executive power without the aid and advice will be unconstitutional.

Extraedge by Onlyias

The Constitution of India provided for a Parliamentary form of government in which a council of ministers headed by the Prime Minister is the real executive authority.

Source of reference Polity Laxmikant

Q.53) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Cabinet is a smaller body consisting of 15 to 20 ministers. It includes the cabinet ministers only. Thus it is a part of the Council of ministers. It supervises the implementation of its decisions by the council of ministers.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** It was inserted in Article 352 of the constitution in 1978 by the 44th constitutional amendment act. Thus it did not find a place in the original text of the constitution.
- **Statement 3 is correct: The Cabinet** is the highest decision making authority in our politico-administrative system. It is an advisory body to the



president and its advice is binding on them. It is also the supreme executive authority in the central government.

Source of reference Laxmikant Polity

Q.54) Ans: B

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: The Prime minister is appointed by the President, while the other ministers are appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister. A minister who is a member of one house of Parliament has the right to speak and to take part in the proceedings, of the other house also, but he can vote only in the house of which he is a member.

Statement 2 is correct: The ministers hold office during the pleasure of the Governor. All executive action of the Government of a state shall be expressed to be taken in the name of the Governor.

Statement 3 is correct: The constitution does not specify the exact size of the state council of ministers or ranking of ministers. They are determined by the chief minister according to the requirement and demand of the situation.

Extraedge by Onlyias

The Governor is the nominal executive authority (*de jure* executive) and the chief minister is the real executive authority(*de facto* executive).

Source of reference Polity Laxmikant

Q.55) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: They are appointed among the members of the legislative assemblies in the state. They often hold the rank of minister of state and are appointed by the chief minister of the state concerned.

Statement 2 is correct: They are ruling party members to assist ministers. They have no department in their control and are attached to senior ministers. They are regarded for all practical purposes and having access to all files and documents.

Source of reference

<https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/Is-the-appointment-of-Parliamentary-Secretary-unconstitutional/article14424083.ece>

Q.56) Ans: A

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The Cabinet secretariat is responsible for the administration of the GoI (Transaction of Business rules), 1961 and GoI (Allocation of business) rules, 1961 facilitating smooth transaction of business in ministries/departments. It assists in decision making in government by ensuring inter-ministerial coordination and evolving consensus.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The cabinet secretariat functions directly under the Prime Minister (and not Home Minister)

Statement 3 is incorrect: The administrative head of the Secretariat is the Cabinet Secretary (and not Chief Secretary) who is also the ex-officio Chairman of the Civil Services Board.

Extraedge by Onlyias

The Chief secretary acts as a secretary to the state cabinet. He acts as the head of state civil services.

Source if reference

<https://cabsec.gov.in/>

Q.57) Ans: C

Exp:

Statement 1 is correct: The post of Chief Secretary is the senior most position held in the civil services of the state or Union territory. He acts as the head of state civil services. Important cases pertaining to transfers, appointment, and promotions of senior state civil servants goes to his/her desk.

Statement 2 is incorrect Cabinet secretary (and not chief secretary) is the administrative head of the Union cabinet secretariat. Chief Secretary is the head of State cabinet secretariat whose functions include secretarial assistance, implementation of decisions and policy coordination

Statement 3 is correct: The Chief secretary also acts as the Principal advisor to the chief minister on all the matters of State administration.



Extraedge by onlyias

Chief secretary is the principle channel of communication between the concerned state government and the Central Government.

Source of reference

<https://www.gktoday.in/upsc-questions/what-are-the-main-functions-of-the-chief-secretary-what-are-recent-arguments-against-the-post-of-chief-secretary/>

Q.58) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The Vice-President occupies the second highest office in the country. The office of Vice President is modelled on the lines of the American Vice-President.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The resolution for removal of the Vice President can be introduced only in the Rajya Sabha and not in the Lok Sabha. However, no such resolution can be moved unless at least 14 days' advance notice has been given.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** The Vice President can be removed from the office before completion of his term. A **formal impeachment is not required** for his removal. He can be **removed by a resolution** passed by a majority of all the then members of the Rajya Sabha and agreed to by the Lok Sabha. This means that this resolution should be passed in the **Rajya Sabha by an effective majority** and in the **Lok Sabha by a simple majority**.

Q.59) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The office of governor of the Indian Constitution has been taken from **Government of India Act, 1935**. The manner of appointment of governor was debated in constituent assembly. The Draft Constitution provided for the direct election of the governor on the basis of universal adult suffrage. But the Constituent Assembly opted for the present system of appointment of governor to avoid conflicts

between chief Minister and Governor. Thus the Canadian model, where the governor of a state(province) is appointed by the Centre (Governor-General) is adopted.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Constitution lays down that the **governor is entitled** to such emoluments, allowances and privileges as may be **determined by Parliament** from time to time.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** When the same person is appointed as the governor of two or more states, the emoluments and allowances payable to him are **shared by the states in such proportion** as determined by the **president**.

Q.60) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect**
A governor holds office for a **term of five years** from the date on which he enters upon his office. However the governor has **no security of tenure**. He may be removed by the President at any time.
- **Statement 2 is correct**
The members of state information commission are **appointed by the Governor** on the recommendation of a committee consisting of the Chief Minister as Chairperson, the Leader of Opposition in the Legislative Assembly and a State Cabinet Minister nominated by the Chief Minister. **Governor can also remove** the State Chief Information Commissioner or any State Information Commissioner from the office.
- **Statement 3 is incorrect**
Governor **cannot pardon a death sentence**. Even if a state law prescribes a death sentence, the power to grant pardon lies with the President and not the governor. However, the governor **can suspend, remit or commute a death sentence**.

Q.61) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** Originally the constitution prescribed for the Chief justice of India and seven judges in Supreme Court and also empowered Parliament of India to increase the number of judges of the Supreme.



However, the number of judges of the High Court is decided by the President.

- **Statement 2 is correct:** A person to be appointed as a judge of the Supreme Court should have the following qualifications:
 1. He should be a citizen of India.
 2. (a) He should have been a judge of a High Court (or high courts in succession) for five years
(b) He should have been an advocate of a High Court (or High Courts in succession) for ten years
(c) He should be a distinguished jurist in the opinion of the president.Thus it is clear that the Constitution has not prescribed a minimum age for appointment as a judge of the Supreme Court.

Q.62) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The constitution does not provide for minimum or maximum number of judges in a high court. The number of judges of the High Court is decided by the President of India.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The Parliament can extend the jurisdiction of a high court to any union territory or exclude the jurisdiction of a high court from any union territory
- **Statement 3 is correct:** According to Representations of People Act, 1951 the disputes regarding election of Member of Parliament and member of state legislature is heard by the High Court. This power of High Court falls under its original jurisdiction.

Q.63) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Option 1 is correct:** Matters related to revenue collection falls under the original jurisdiction of High Court
- **Option 2 is correct:** enforcement of fundamental rights falls under original jurisdiction of High Court
- **Option 3 is correct:** Cases requiring interpretation of constitution that are

transferred from subordinate Court falls under original jurisdiction of High Court

- **Option 4 is incorrect:** Dispute relating to election of Panchayat members is adjudicated as mentioned in state legislative acts. Thus they do not fall under original jurisdiction of High Court

Q.64) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The above disqualification on the ground of defection does not apply in the following two cases:
 - (a) If a **member goes out of his party as a result of a merger** of the party with another party. A merger takes place when two-thirds of the members of the party have agreed to such merger.
 - (b) If a member, **after being elected as the presiding officer of the House, voluntarily gives up** the membership of his party or rejoins it after he ceases to hold that office. This exemption has been provided in view of the dignity and impartiality of this office.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** Any question regarding disqualification arising out of defection is to be **decided by the presiding officer** of the House
- **Statement 3 is incorrect:** Originally, the act provided that the decision of the presiding officer is final and cannot be questioned in any court. However, in the **Kihoto Hollohan case**, the Supreme Court **declared this provision as unconstitutional** on the ground that it seeks to take away the jurisdiction of the Supreme Court and the high courts. It held that the presiding officer, while deciding a question under the Tenth Schedule, **function as a tribunal**. Hence, his decision like that of any other tribunal, is subject to judicial review

Q.65) Ans: C

Exp:



- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The salary and allowances of the Chief Minister are **determined by the state legislature**. In addition to the salary and allowances, which are payable to a member of the state legislature, he gets a sumptuary allowance, free accommodation, travelling allowance, medical facilities
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** The term of the Chief Minister is not fixed and he holds office during the pleasure of the governor. However, this does not mean that the governor can dismiss him at any time. He cannot be dismissed by the governor as long as he enjoys the majority support in the legislative assembly

Q.66) Ans: D

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** The Cabinet Secretary is ex-officio head of the Civil Services Board and the Cabinet Secretariat. He is also the head of the IAS and all civil services under the rules of business of the Government of India.
- **Statement 2 is correct:** The Cabinet Secretary is responsible to provide Secretarial assistance to the Cabinet and its Committees. He is also instrumental in attaining inter-ministerial coordination and smooth functioning among various Ministries.
- **Statement 3 is correct:** Cabinet Secretary is also responsible to evolve consensus through the instrumentality of a standing as well as ad hoc committees of the secretaries

Q.67) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:** Cabinet Secretary is the senior most bureaucrat of the country. Cabinet Secretary assists in decision making of the government. He is appointed for a fixed term of 2 years.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** According to All India Services 1958, the government can give extension in service to a cabinet secretary provided the total tenure does not exceed four

years. The central government may give an extension in service for a further period not exceeding three months, beyond the period of four years to a cabinet secretary.

Q.68) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:** The total number of ministers, including the Prime Minister, in the Council of Ministers shall not exceed 15% of the total strength of the Lok Sabha. This Provision was added by 91st Amendment Act 2003.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:** A minister who is a member of one House of Parliament has the right to speak and to take part in the proceedings of the other House also, but he can vote only in the House of which he is a member
- **Statement 3 is correct:** A person who is not a member of either House of the Parliament can also be appointed as a Minister. however you will have to become a Minister of any house of the Parliament within 6 months office appointment as the minister of the Council

Q.69) Ans: B

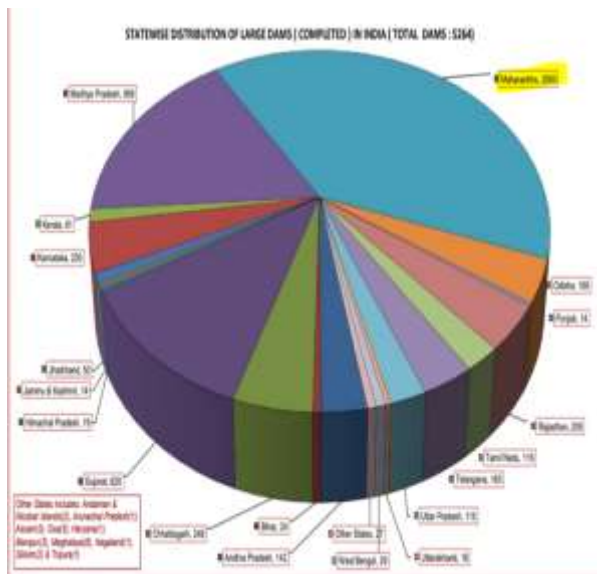
Exp:

- **option 1 is correct:** the President is the head of Executive. All the decisions of the executive taken under his name.
- **option 2 is correct:** The Vice President is also a part of the Executive.
- **option 3 is correct:** All the members of the Council of Ministers are part of the union executive.
- **option 4 is incorrect:** Advocate general is the highest legal officer of the Executive and is a part of it. However there is no mention of solicitor-general as part of union executive

Q.70) Ans: D

Exp:

Statement 1 is incorrect: The total number of ministers including the chief minister in the Council of Ministers in a state shall not exceed 15% of the total strength of the Legislative Assembly of that state but the number



of ministers including the chief minister in a state shall not be less than 12.

Statement 2 is incorrect: The Governor has the right to address and send messages to the State Legislative Assembly and State Legislative Council. There is no provision regarding addressing and sending messages to the Council of Ministers.

Q.71) Ans: A

Exp:

- At a whopping **2069**, **Maharashtra** has the most Large dams in India with a further 285 dams under construction at present. Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat follow.
- Large dams have been defined as per the definition of **International Commission on Large Dam (ICOLD)**. Recently, the definition of large dam has been modified by ICOLD in 2018. As per modified definition, a dam which satisfies following criteria is considered to be a large dam.
 - A dam with a **height of 15 metres or greater from lowest foundation to crest**.
 - A dam between **5 metres and 15 metres** impounding more than 3 million cubic metres of water

NEWS: [The problem of ageing dams - The Hindu](#)

Q.72) Ans: D

Exp:

- Options 1,3 and 5 are correct:**
 - Students are advised to Refer to the detailed map here.



NEWS: [India delivers 2 cranes for Chabahar port - The Hindu](#)

Q.73) Ans: D

Exp:

- In **Budget 2021-22**, The government in the Budget unveiled the Disinvestment/Strategic Disinvestment Policy and identified four sectors where CPSEs would be retained
 - Atomic energy, Space and Defence (national security)**
 - Transport and Telecommunications (critical infrastructure)**
 - Power, Petroleum, Coal and other minerals (energy and minerals)**
 - Banking, Insurance and financial services.**
- The Central Public Sector Enterprises (**CPSEs**) in other sectors would be privatised or can be

closed, or merged, or made subsidiary of other CPSEs. The Secretary in the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM), which manages government equity in public sector companies, said that the strategic disinvestment policy is an important directional shift and gives a broad idea to the private sector about which companies could be up for sale.

- *Aspirants are advised to master the map of this region because of the recent Chamoli disaster*

NEWS: [Uttarakhand glacier burst | Experts point to climate change impact - The Hindu](#)

- [Uttarakhand glacier burst | Dhauliganga's water level at Joshimath breaches records, say Central Water Commission - The Hindu](#)

NEWS: [GoM to decide PSU count in strategic sectors: DIPAM Secretary \(livemint.com\)](#)

Q.75) Ans: C

Exp:

- The Global Risks Report is an annual study published by the World Economic Forum ahead of the Forum's Annual Meeting in Davos, Switzerland. Based on the work of the Global Risk Network, the report describes changes occurring in the global risks landscape from year to year. The report also explores the interconnectedness of risks, and considers how the strategies for the mitigation of global risks might be structured.
- The WEF's Global Risks report for 2021 states that environmental risks continue to threaten the global economy. The top five risks are extreme weather, climate action failure, human environmental damage, infectious diseases and biodiversity loss. In terms of impact, infectious diseases top the list, followed by climate action failure. The top two risk response blind spots are climate action failure and biodiversity loss.

NEWS: [Towards sustainable growth - The Hindu](#)

Q.76) Ans: B

Exp:

- Option 1 is incorrect and Options 2,3 and 5 are correct:
 - Fiscal conservatism is a political and economic philosophy regarding fiscal policy and fiscal responsibility advocating low taxes, reduced government spending and minimal government debt.

Q.74) Ans: A

Exp:

- The Panch Prayag is an expression in Hindu religious ethos, specifically used to connote the five sacred river confluences in the Garhwal Himalayas in the state of Uttarakhand, India. The five prayags - prayag meaning "place of confluence of rivers" in Sanskrit - also termed as "Prayag pentad" are Vishnuprayag, Nandaprayag, Karnaprayag, Rudraprayag and Devprayag, in the descending flow sequence of their occurrence.



- As shown, The Four rivers meet Alaknanda at the various Prayags, before the Alaknanda meets the Bhagirathi to form River Ganga at Devprayag.



- Deregulation, free trade, privatization and tax cuts are its defining qualities.
- Experts have suggested that the recent Budget 2020-21 was an attempt to **move away from Fiscal orthodoxy or Fiscal Conservatism**. The change in fiscal stance is part of a selective departure from market orthodoxy that has marked the government's economic policy in the last few years.
 - The government has increased duties on some imports in order to protect and foster domestic industry. It has introduced performance-linked incentives for designated sectors, something that goes counter to market economics.
 - The government is, however, happy to adhere to other elements of market orthodoxy, such as privatisation and a greater role for foreign direct investment (FDI).
- **Option 4 is incorrect:**
 - Repo and policy rate cuts are Monetary tools and not fiscal tools. It hence is a part of Monetary policy.

NEWS: [It's goodbye to fiscal orthodoxy - The Hindu](#)

Q.77) Ans: A

Exp:

- The International Criminal Court
 - The ICC is an intergovernmental organization and international tribunal that sits in The Hague, Netherlands. The ICC is the first and only permanent international court with jurisdiction to prosecute individuals for the international crimes of genocide, crimes against humanity, war crimes and the crime of aggression.
 - It is intended to complement existing national judicial systems and it may

therefore exercise its jurisdiction only when national courts are unwilling or unable to prosecute criminals.

- The ICC may only investigate and prosecute crimes committed within member states, crimes committed by nationals of member states, or crimes in situations referred to the Court by the United Nations Security Council.
- The ICC began operations on 1 July 2002, upon the entry into force of the Rome Statute, a multilateral treaty that serves as the court's foundational and governing document. States which become party to the Rome Statute become members of the ICC, serving on the Assembly of States Parties, which administers the court. As of December 2020, there are 123 ICC member states

NEWS: [International Criminal Court convicts Ugandan rebel commander for war crimes - The Hindu](#)

Q.78) Ans: D

Exp:

- All options are correct:
 - In India, the Information Technology Act, 2000, as amended from time to time, governs all activities related to the use of computer resources. It covers all 'intermediaries' who play a role in the use of computer resources and electronic records.
 - The term 'intermediaries' includes providers of:
 - telecom service
 - network service
 - Internet service and web hosting
 - search engines
 - online payment and auction sites
 - online marketplaces and
 - cyber cafes.
 - It includes any person who, on behalf of another, "receives, stores or transmits" any electronic record.



Social media platforms would fall under this definition.

- Section 69 of the Act confers on the Central and State governments the power to issue directions “to intercept, monitor or decrypt...any information generated, transmitted, received or stored in any computer resource”. The grounds on which these powers may be exercised are: in the interest of the **sovereignty or integrity of India, defence of India, security of the state, friendly relations with foreign states, public order, or for preventing incitement to the commission of any cognisable offence relating to these, or for investigating any offence.**

NEWS: [Explained | Why has the Centre issued a notice to Twitter, and what are the laws governing the cyber world? - The Hindu](#)

Q.79) Ans: A

Exp:

Option A is correct

- Both **Main Central Thrust** and **Main boundary thrust** are major geological faults where the Indian Plate has pushed under the Eurasian Plate along the Himalaya.
- **Recently, A snow avalanche triggered possibly by a landslide** caused a flash flood in the Rishi Ganga river, a tributary of the Alaknanda in **Chamoli** district of Uttarakhand, on a sunny morning on February 7, washing away a functional small hydroelectric project and destroying the under-construction 520 MW Tapovan Vishnugad project of the NTPC on the Dhaul Ganga river
- In an article in Current Science in 2014, geologist K.S. Valdiya pointed to the fragility of the entire landscape from a geological point of view: “**As the northward moving peninsular India presses on, the lesser Himalaya rock assemblages are compressed and are pushed under the huge pile of the Great Himalayan rocks, the latter riding southwards onto and over the lesser Himalaya. The movement has been going on since the MCT [the Main**

Central Thrust] was formed 20-22 million years ago.

- The result of these geological stresses, scientists say, is **weakening of rocks, making the development of large dam projects in the region unwise.**

- **NEWS :** [The Hindu Explains | Why are geologists worried about a slew of hydroelectric projects and environmental stress in Uttarakhand? - The Hindu](#)

Q.80) Ans: A

Exp:

Statements 1,2 and 4 are correct:

- The Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR) recently announced the conclusion of a six-month exercise of conducting a “whole-genome sequence” of 1,008 Indians. The project is part of a programme called “**IndiGen**” and is also seen as a **precursor to a much larger exercise involving other government** departments to map a larger swathe of the population in the country. Sequencing a genome means **deciphering the exact order of base pairs in an individual.**
- Some current and potential **applications of genome research include**
 - Energy sources and environmental applications
 - Risk assessment
 - Bioarchaeology, anthropology, evolution, and human migration
 - DNA forensics (identification)
 - Agriculture, livestock breeding, and bioprocessing.
- **Molecular Medicine**
 - Improved diagnosis of disease
 - **Earlier detection of genetic predispositions to disease**
 - **Rational drug design**
 - Gene therapy and control systems for drugs
 - Pharmacogenomics “**custom drugs**”
 - **genotyping of specific viruses** to direct appropriate treatment



- identification of mutations linked to different forms of **cancer**
- advancement in forensic applied sciences;
- Technology and resources promoted by the **erstwhile Human Genome Project** are starting to have profound impacts on biomedical research and promise to revolutionize the wider spectrum of biological research and clinical medicine

Q.81) Ans: B

Exp:

Option B is correct

- A committee headed by retired Supreme Court Judge **Justice BN Srikrishna** has submitted its report on "**Data Protection Framework**" to the Government.
- The Committee was constituted by the union government in July 2017, to deliberate on a data protection framework. The Supreme Court in its **Puttaswamy judgment**, 2017 declared **privacy a fundamental right**. This set the government in motion to take **steps to bring a new data protection legislation for the country**.
- The report has **emphasized that interests of the citizens and the responsibilities of the state have to be protected**, but not at the cost of trade and industry. The Committee has also proposed a **draft Personal Data Protection Bill**.

Q.82) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect and statement 2 is correct**
 - According to **Article 279A of the Constitution**, The Goods and Services Tax Council shall consist of the following members, namely
 - the Union Finance Minister—Chairperson
 - the **Union Minister of State in charge of Revenue or Finance—Member**

- the Minister in charge of Finance or Taxation or any other Minister nominated by each State Government—Members.
- The **Members of the Goods and Services Tax Council** shall, as soon as may be, choose one amongst themselves to be the **Vice-Chairperson of the Council** for such period as they may decide.

- **One-half of the total number of Members** of the Goods and Services Tax Council shall constitute the quorum at its meetings.

- the **vote of the Central Government** shall have a **weightage of one-third** of the total votes cast, and
- the **votes of all the State Governments** taken together shall have a **weightage of two-thirds** of the **total votes** cast, in that meeting.

NEWS:

<https://www.thehindu.com/business/Industry/commercial-markets-across-india-to-remain-shut-on-february-26-traders-body-cait/article33871448.ece>

Q.83) Ans: C

Exp:

Option C is correct

- **Bhimbetka Caves:**
 - The Bhimbetka rock shelters are an archaeological site in central India that spans the prehistoric Paleolithic and Mesolithic periods, as well as the historic period. It exhibits the **earliest traces of human life in India and evidence of Stone Age starting at the site in Acheulian times**. It is located in the **Raisen District in the Indian state of Madhya Pradesh about 45 kilometres (28 mi) south-east of Bhopal**.
 - It is a **UNESCO World Heritage Site** that consists of **seven hills and over**



750 rock shelters distributed over 10 km. At least some of the shelters were inhabited more than **100,000 years ago**. The rock shelters and caves provide evidence of a "rare glimpse" into human settlement and cultural evolution from hunter-gatherers, to agriculture, and expressions of prehistoric spirituality.

NEWS: [Fossils of 'Dickinsonia' found at Bhimbetka - The Hindu](#)

Q.84) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:**
 - The prices of petroleum products including LPG in the country are linked to the prices of respective products in the international market. However, the Government continues to modulate the effective price to consumer for Subsidised Domestic LPG and the consumers get the products at subsidised rate. The subsidy on Subsidised Domestic LPG increase/decrease with the increase/decrease in the product price in international market and decision of Government on subsidy.
- **Statement 2 is incorrect:**
 - Recently, It was discussed that the price of fertilisers is undergoing an increase due to the rising prices of phosphoric acid, ammonia etc internationally. Despite this, A historic decision was taken to increase the subsidy for DAP (Diammonium Phosphate) fertiliser from Rs. 500 per bag to Rs. 1200 per bag, which is an increase of 140%. Thus, despite the rise in international market prices of DAP, it has been decided to continue selling it at the older price of Rs.1200 and the central government has decided to bear all the burden of price hike.

NEWS: [Subsidy given up on LPG cylinders](#)

Q.85) Ans: C

Exp:

- The Paris Call for Trust and Security in Cyberspace (2018) is a call to come together to face the new threats endangering citizens and infrastructure. It is based around nine common principles to secure cyberspace, which act as many areas for discussion and action.
- The Paris Call invites all cyberspace actors to work together and encourage States to cooperate with private sector partners, the world of research and civil society. The supporters of the Paris Call commit to working together to adopt responsible behaviour and implement within cyberspace the fundamental principles which apply in the physical world.
- Similarly, 52 countries and international bodies have signed the Christchurch Call to Action to eliminate terrorist and violent extremist content online.

NEWS: [Disinformation is a cybersecurity threat - The Hindu](#)

Q.86) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Options 1 and 4 are correct:**
 - The eight Committees of the Cabinet are:
 - Appointments Committee of the Cabinet
 - Cabinet Committee on Accommodation
 - Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs
 - Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs
 - Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs
 - Cabinet Committee on Security
 - Cabinet Committee on Investment and growth



- Cabinet Committee on Employment & Skill Development
- All committees of the cabinet **except that of Parliamentary Affairs and Accommodation** are chaired by the Prime Minister.
 - Presently, the Cabinet Committee on Accommodation is headed by the Home Minister while the Cabinet Committee on Parliamentary Affairs is headed by the Defence Minister.

NEWS:

<https://pib.gov.in/Pressreleaseshare.aspx?PRID=1573622>

<https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=1696734>

Q.87) Ans: B

Exp:

- Statement 1 is incorrect:
 - FASTag is a **RFID passive tag** used for making toll payments directly from the customers linked prepaid or savings/current account. It is affixed on the windscreen of the vehicle and enables the customer to drive through toll plazas, without stopping for any toll payments
 - **Active RFID tags** have a transmitter and their own power source (typically a battery). The power source is used to run the microchip's circuitry and to broadcast a signal to a reader (the way a cell phone transmits signals to a base station).
 - **Passive tags** have no battery. Instead, they draw power from the reader, which sends out electromagnetic waves that induce a current in the tag's antenna.

- **Semi-passive tags** use a battery to run the chip's circuitry, but communicate by drawing power from the reader

- Statements 2 and 3 are correct:

- **National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has developed the National Electronic Toll Collection (NETC)** program to meet the electronic tolling requirements of the Indian market. It offers an interoperable nationwide toll payment solution including clearing house services for settlement and dispute management. Interoperability, as it applies to the National Electronic Toll Collection (NETC) system, encompasses a common set of processes, business rules and technical specifications **which enable a customer to use their FASTag as payment mode on any of the toll plazas irrespective of who has acquired the toll plaza.**
 - The toll fare is directly deducted from the linked account of the customer. **FASTag is also vehicle specific and once it is affixed to a vehicle, it cannot be transferred to another vehicle.** FASTag can be purchased from any of the NETC Member Banks. If a FASTag is linked to the prepaid account, then it needs to be recharged/ topped-up as per the usage of the customer.

NEWS: [FASTag compulsory at all toll plazas from midnight](#)

Q.88) Ans: C

Exp:

Option C is correct

- In India, **Environmental Clearance (EC)** is issued by **The Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MoEFCC)** / State Environment Impact Assessment Authority (SEIAA) as per the **Environment Impact Assessment Notification 2006** under the **Environment (Protection) Act 1986.**
- The project proponents are also required to obtain **Consent to Establish (CTE)** and **Consent**

to Operate (CTO) under the **Air (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act- 1981** and **Water (Prevention and Control of Pollution) Act, 1974** from **State Pollution Control Boards (SPCB) of States/UTs.**

- In order to get Environment Clearance for new projects, the **Project Proponent (PP)** has to **submit an application at Parivesh portal for Terms of Reference (TOR)** which is generally issued in a month's time. Thereafter, **normally one season (4 months) time is spent in the Environment Impact Assessment Study** and this duration should be continuous and excluding the rainy season.

NEWS: [Keep tabs on clearance conditions for projects: NGT](#)

Q.89) Ans: D

Exp:

Option D is correct

- Banni Grasslands Reserve or Banni grasslands form a belt of arid grassland ecosystem on the outer southern edge of the desert of the marshy salt **flats of Rann of Kutch in Kutch District, Gujarat State, India.**

They are currently legally protected under the status as a protected or reserve forest in India. Wildlife Institute of India (WII) has identified this grassland reserve as one of the last remaining habitats of the **cheetah in India and a possible reintroduction site**



- Banni grassland is peculiar to the Rann of Kutch, it has **some forty Sindhi speaking Maldhari (cattle breeders) hamlets**, home to the Halaypotra, Hingora, Hingorja, Jat and Mutwa tribes

- In dark nights an **unexplained strange dancing light phenomena known locally as Chir Batti (Ghost lights)** is known to occur here in the banni grasslands and its seasonal marshy wetlands.

NEWS: <https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/energy-and-environment/ecologically-and-culturally-rich-deserts-swamps-and-grasslands-must-not-be-labelled-wastelands/article33037900.ece>

Q.90) Ans: A

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is correct:**

- When before the expiration of the term of office of a member of the Rajya Sabha, his seat becomes **vacant or is declared vacant or his election is declared void**, the **Election Commission**, by a notification calls upon the elected members of the **Legislative Assembly/members of the electoral college** concerned to elect a person to fill the casual vacancy. The bye-election is required to be held **within six months of the occurrence of the vacancy.**

- A member elected to **fill a casual vacancy holds office** for the **remainder of the term of his predecessor.**
- However, this will not apply if
 - the remainder of the term of a member in relation to a vacancy is less than one year or
 - The **Election Commission** in consultation with the **Central Government** certifies that it is difficult to hold the bye-election within that period.

- **Statement 2 is incorrect:**

- In the **case of a casual vacancy in the seat of a nominated member**, the term of office of the **member**

nominated to fill that seat commences from the date of notification issued under sub-clause (a) of clause (1) of article 80 of the Constitution. That member also serves for the remainder of his predecessor's term of office.

NEWS: Extra research based on the recent proceedings in the Parliament

Q.91) Ans: A

Exp:

- Options 1,2,4 and 6 are correct:
 - White goods, synonymous with a **major appliance**, are large home appliances such as **stoves, refrigerators, freezers, washing machines, tumble driers, dishwashers, air conditioners and LED Lights**. They are **large electrical goods for the house which were traditionally available only in white**. Even though you can purchase them today in a wide range of different colors, they continue being called white goods. They are generally non-portable or semi-portable machines used for **routine housekeeping tasks such as cooking, washing laundry, or food preservation**.
 - The term contrasts with **brown goods**, which are relatively **small light electronic consumer durables** such as **computers, digital media players, TVs and radios**.
 - **White goods** are also different from a **plumbing fixture (Pipes, bathtubs, urinals, channel drains)** because they use **electricity or fuel**.

NEWS: [Union Budget 2021: Production linked incentive schemes announced for 13 sectors](#)

Q.92) Ans: A

Exp:

- Option A is correct
 - **Centre for High Technology (CHT)**, a technical body under the aegis of Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas (MoP&NG), will be implementing the **Pradhan Mantri JI-VAN (Jaiv**

Indhan- Vatavaran Anukool fasal awashesh Nivaran) Yojana which aims to provide financial support to Integrated Bioethanol Projects using lignocellulosic biomass and other renewable feedstock.

- The CHT was established in **1987** to **assess futuristic requirements, acquire, develop and adopt technologies in the fields of refinery processes, petroleum products**, work relating to modernisation of technologies etc. It is a Society, under **Societies Registration Act of 1860**.

NEWS: [Pradhan Mantri JI-VAN yojana — Vikaspedia](#)

Q.93) Ans: C

Exp:



Option C is correct

- The Fujiwhara effect, sometimes referred to as the Fujiwara effect, or binary interaction, is a **phenomenon that occurs when two nearby cyclonic vortices move around each other and close the distance between the circulations of their corresponding low-pressure areas**.
- When two cyclones or hurricanes near each other, the two storms can interact. The two storms will start to circulate around each other, drawing closer together. The stronger of the two storms **will often eventually absorb the smaller storm**. In other instances, **two storms of equal strength may either merge or spin** around a common center before moving off into separate paths.

NEWS: [Fujiwhara Effect: When One Storm Absorbs Another - Geography Realm](#)

Q.94) Ans: C

Exp:

- **Options 1,3,4 and 5 are correct:**
- The **National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR)** emphasises the **principle**

of universality and inviolability of child rights for all children in the 0 to 18 years age group.

- The Commission shall perform all or any of the following functions, namely:
- Examine and review the **safeguards provided by or under any law for the time being in force for the protection of child rights.**
- Present to the **central government (not president)** annually and at such other intervals, as the commission may deem fit, **reports upon working of those safeguards**
- **Study treaties and other international instruments** and undertake periodic review of existing policies, programmes, and other activities on child rights and make recommendations for their effective implementation in the best interest of children.
- **Undertake and promote research** in the field of child rights.
- Inquire into complaints and take **suo moto notice** of matters related to:
 - Deprivation and violation of child rights.
 - Non implementation of laws providing for protection and development of children.
 - Non compliance of policy decisions, guidelines or instructions aimed at mitigating hardships
 - **Spread child rights literacy among various sections of society** and promote awareness of the safeguards available for protection of these rights through publications, media, seminars and other available means.

NEWS: [Report admonishes NCPDR for its Shaheen Bagh directive](#)

Q.95) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Options 2,4 and 5 are correct**
- The Sahel is the **ecoclimatic and biogeographic realm of transition in Africa between the Sahara to the north and the Sudanian savanna to the south.** Having a semi-arid climate, it stretches across the south-central latitudes of Northern Africa between the Atlantic Ocean and the Red Sea.
- -As shown in the map, the Sahel part of Africa includes from west to east parts of northern **Senegal**, southern **Mauritania**, central **Mali**, northern **Burkina Faso**, the extreme south of

Algeria, Niger, the extreme north of Nigeria, the extreme north of Cameroon and Central African Republic, central Chad, central and southern Sudan, the extreme north of South Sudan, Eritrea and the extreme north of Ethiopia

NEWS:

<https://blogs.worldbank.org/nasikiliza/towards-more-sustainable-future-sahel-region>

Q.96) Ans: C

Exp:

Option C is correct

- **Artemis Accords**
- The Artemis Accords are an international agreement between governments participating in the **Artemis Program, an NASA led effort to return humans to the Moon by 2024**, and to ultimately expand and deepen space exploration
- Drafted under the auspices of the **American space agency, NASA**, the Accords establish a framework for cooperation in the **civil exploration and peaceful use of the Moon, Mars, and other astronomical objects.**
- They are **explicitly grounded in the United Nations Outer Space Treaty of 1967**, whose principles they aim to implement and reinforce, and cite most of the major UN-brokered conventions constituting space law.
- The Accords were signed on 13 October 2020 by the directors of the national space agencies of eight countries: the United States, Australia, Canada, Japan, Luxembourg, Italy, the United Kingdom, and the United Arab Emirates
 - Recently, South Korea, Ukraine and New Zealand have also joined the accords.

Article:

https://link.springer.com/chapter/10.1007/978-981-15-8924-9_6

Q.97) Ans: D

Exp:

All option is correct:



- **Aquaponics is a form of agriculture** that combines **raising fish in tanks** (recirculating aquaculture) with soilless plant culture (**hydroponics**). In aquaponics, **the nutrient-rich water from raising fish provides a natural fertilizer for the plants and the plants help to purify the water for the fish**. **Various advantages are:**
 - **Significant reduction in the usage of water** : as Most or all of the water is recycled and it is not necessary to discard or change any water (under normal conditions). This also makes it an effective farming technique in dry regions.
- **Significantly faster growth of plants is possible:** Plants Grow Faster – Because plants have access to nutrients 24 hours a day. For example, the aquaponic system speeds up the growth of lettuce from two months to one month.
- Aquaponics is a balanced and self-contained ecosystem. **No chemicals or fertilizers are added or needed** to help the plants grow and thrive in an aquaponics system. There is no reliance on mined and manufactured fertilizers otherwise the fish will simply die. The Produce is **free of pesticides and herbicides**. Further, Fish are free of growth hormones and antibiotics.
- Since both the **fish and the plants** can be used for **consumption and income generation**, the method delivers a two-fold benefit.
- Eliminating soil **eliminates soil borne diseases**.
- Efficient, sustainable and highly productive and hence allows continuous production of food.

NEWS: [Amid Lockdown, Kerala Daily Wager Bred 300 Kg Fish & Grew Aquaponic Veggies on Terrace](#)

Q.98) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Statement 1 is incorrect:**
 - Under the SS Code, the provision of maternity benefit has not been made

universal. Maternity benefit is **presently applicable for establishments employing 10 workers or more.** The definition of 'Establishment' in the **proposed code did not include the unorganised sector.** Hence, women engaged in the **unorganised sector** would remain outside the purview of maternity benefit.

• **Statement 2 is correct:**

- A positive feature is that the Social Security Code promises the establishment of social security funds for **unorganised workers, as well as gig and platform workers**, and also says their **welfare would be addressed** by the National Social Security Board.
- According to the code,
- **"gig worker"** means a person who performs **work or participates in a work arrangement and earns from such activities outside of traditional employer-employee relationship;**
- **"Platform work"** means a work arrangement outside of a traditional employer employee relationship in which organisations or individuals **use an online platform to access other organisations or individuals to solve specific problems** or to provide specific services or any such other activities which may be notified by the Central Government, in exchange for payment;

Q.99) Ans: B

Exp:

- **Options 2,3,4,6 and 7 are correct**
- As defined by the **International Union of Pure and Applied Chemistry (IUPAC)**, rare earth elements are a set of 17 chemical elements in the periodic table, including the 15 lanthanides plus scandium and yttrium. Their abbreviation is **REE**. The **17 elements are considered together as one group due to their similar chemical properties**, which make them indispensable and non-replaceable in **electronic, metallurgy, magnetic, catalytic and some other high-technology areas.**

Despite rare earth elements being relatively abundant in the Earth's crust, **the ores containing REE vary and their distribution is scattered**. Therefore, it is not common to find them in commercially viable concentrations, hence **they are named rare earth elements**.

The 17 elements are:

- lanthanum, cerium, praseodymium
- **neodymium**, promethium, **samarium**
- europium, **gadolinium**, **terbium**
- dysprosium, holmium, erbium
- thulium, ytterbium, **lutetium**
- scandium, **yttrium**
- Rare earth minerals, with names like **neodymium, praseodymium and dysprosium, are crucial to the manufacture of magnets used in industries of the future**, such as **wind turbines and electric cars**. And they are already being used in consumer goods such as **smartphones, computer screens and telescopic lenses**.
 - In 2019, the **U.S. imported 80% of its rare earth minerals from China**, the U.S. Geological Survey says. The **EU gets 98% of its supply from China**, the European Commission said last year.
- **Thorium is not a rare earth mineral**. Instead, the **production of rare earth oxides creates radioactive waste in the form of thorium**. This material is considered a liability in the processing of rare earths. However, science is quickly developing ways to use the material as nuclear fuel, either in **next generation nuclear facilities, or as a substitute to uranium**
 - **Monazite**, on the other hand, is a primarily reddish-brown phosphate mineral that contains rare-earth elements. Due to variability in composition, **monazite is considered a group of minerals**.

IAS (Ecology) 2013

Due to improper/indiscriminate disposal of old and used computers of their parts, which of the following are released into the environment as e-waste?

1. Beryllium
2. Cadmium
3. Chromium
4. Heptachlor
5. Mercury
6. Lead
7. Plutonium

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

Q.100) Ans: C

Exp:

Option C is correct

- In a major boost to export of GI certified products, **Shahi Litchi from Bihar** was exported to United Kingdom
- **Shahi litchi** became the **fourth** agricultural product to get GI certification from Bihar in 2018, after **Jardalu mango, Katarni rice and Magahi paan**. GI registration for Shahi Litchi is held with the Muzaffarpur-based Litchi Growers Association of Bihar.
 - **India is the second largest producer of litchi (Litchi chin) in the world, after China**. The translucent, flavoured aril or edible flesh of the litchi is popular as a table fruit in India, while in China and Japan it is preferred in dried or canned form. **Bihar tops in terms of production of litchi**.

BASED on this question: